



QUICKLY.

**Adani Energy Q4 profit grows 6% to ₹684 crore**



**Ahmedabad:** Adani Energy Solutions reported a modest rise in quarterly profit on higher revenues and steady operational performance, even as the base was impacted by one-off gains last year. The Adani Group's transmission and distribution arm posted a 6 per cent on-year increase in consolidated net profit at ₹684 crore for the March quarter, while revenue from operations rose 17 per cent to ₹7,443 crore, reflecting improved execution across its core businesses. Adjusted for a one-time deferred tax gain of ₹148 crore in the year-ago quarter, profit for Q4 stood at ₹723 crore, marking a sharper 28 per cent on-year growth, aided by stronger operating profitability. For the full year, the company's performance was more robust. Total income rose 15.9 per cent to ₹28,325 crore, while EBITDA grew 12.7 per cent to ₹8,726 crore. OUR BUREAU

# Amazon India to invest ₹2,800 cr in well-being, growth of associates

**INDIA SCALE-UP.** E-comm major says programmes are aligned with new labour codes

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**  
New Delhi

Amazon India plans to invest over ₹2,800 crore to strengthen safety, health and financial well-being measures for its associates and ramp up its operations network. This is part of the broader plan to invest more than \$35 billion in India by 2030. The funding comes at a time when it is expanding its core e-commerce and quick commerce footprint and moving to more than double Amazon Now's footprint in existing cities and expand into urban centres.

“At the heart of our operations network are our people, and we remain committed to raising the bar on associate safety, health and financial wellbeing. This year, we are investing over ₹2,800 crore (~USD 300 million) to further strengthen these efforts, while continuing to scale our operations network and advance the technology that enables faster, safer, and more reli-



**NEAR-TERM STRATEGY.** The move is part of its broader plan to invest \$35 billion in India by 2030 REUTERS

able deliveries. Our initiatives also align with national priorities such as Ayushman Bharat and Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana, helping expand access to healthcare and financial inclusion for our associates,” said Abhinav Singh, V-P, Operations, Amazon India and Australia.

**REST FACILITIES**

The e-commerce major said its programmes for associates are aligned with several of the standards notified under the labour codes. “The

efforts in 2026 include scaling Project Ashray to provide accessible rest facilities for delivery associates, expanding health and wellness programmes such as Sushruta, along with new initiatives, while enabling access to preventive healthcare through nationwide medical camps,” the company said.

It is also enhancing medical and accident insurance for associates while extending financial inclusion and social security access through the Samridhhi pro-

gramme by enabling enrolment in schemes such as Ayushman Bharat Health Account and Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana. Under the Pratidhi programme, it is scaling up efforts to provide scholarships and mentorship to the children of associates.

The e-commerce major said it is making further investments to expand and upgrade its pan-India operations network to increase capacity and improve delivery speeds. This includes setting new fulfilment centres, sorting centres and delivery stations. “These investments will enable Amazon to serve customers across a wide range of delivery speeds from minutes to hours to days, based on their needs,” the company said.

The company said it continues to invest in cooling solutions, including enhanced ventilation, fans, spot coolers, access to cold water and hydrating beverages, safety and accessibility features for people with disabilities, and improved rest areas.

# Tata’s gigascale battery plants enter 18-month phase ahead of 2027 rollout

**Amit Vijay Mohile**  
Mumbai

Tata Group's £4-billion push into gigascale battery manufacturing is shifting from steel and concrete to the make-or-break phase of production ramp-up. With its gigafactories in Somerset, UK, and Sanand, Gujarat, now structurally complete and moving into fit-out, the group has an 18-month sprint to convert capital intensity into stable, commercial-grade output.

Top officials, aware of the developments, told *businessline* that structural steel work is complete at both sites, marking the shift to the shell-and-core phase.

With civil construction complete at Somerset and Sanand sites, focus has shifted decisively to industrialisation. “Converting a steel shell into a functional gigafactory hinges on three layers: Cleanroom commissioning, supply chain alignment and workforce ramp-up,” they said.

Industry estimates suggest this transition typically takes 9–12 months.

“The 40 GWh Somerset facility has moved into cladding and roofing, with pilot production targeted for late 2026 and commercial rollout by early 2027. Alongside, the 20 GWh Sanand plant is transitioning to systems and process installation, with trial production expected in early 2027,” sources further clarified.

Together, the two facilities form the backbone of Tata's strategy to internalise battery supply across Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) and Tata Motors. For JLR, the Somers-



set facility is central to its electric transition, providing a stable, local battery supply for its upcoming premium EV lineup with high-energy-density NMC cells, including next-generation Jaguar models such as the electric GT and electric Range Rover platforms.

The India facility, by contrast, is expected to focus on LFP chemistry for cost-sensitive, high-volume EVs under Tata Motors' Acti.ev architecture, covering newer models such as the Harrier EV and the upcoming Sierra EV, alongside the Nexon EV, Punch EV, Tiago EV, and the next-generation Avinya range. “Both plants are being engineered for flexibility, with lines capable of shifting across chemistries as demand evolves,” they explained.

**FUNDING & EXECUTION**

The £4-billion investment is a layered capital stack combining private investment with public support.

The bulk is estimated at over £3 billion, and comes from the Tata Group through Agratas, funding core infrastructure, cleanroom environments and manufacturing equipment.

This is supplemented by UK government support, including a £380-million grant

formally confirmed on April 9, 2026, during a site visit by UK Secretary of State for Science, Innovation and Technology Peter Kyle.

The funding, part of a broader £700-million advanced manufacturing package under the DRIVE35 Automotive Transformation Fund, had been under subsidy review since late 2025 and is now cleared for deployment, alongside a £750-million bank loan secured last year.

The timing is critical, supporting the transition into cleanroom installation and equipment commissioning — the most execution-sensitive phase of a gigafactory build, where capital deployment peaks.

**LOCALISATION, PLI PLAY**

Central to the Agratas strategy is localisation — both as a cost lever and a policy-alignment tool. By moving into cell manufacturing, Tata Motors is shifting from assembling battery packs to in-sourcing the single most expensive component of an EV, which typically accounts for 35–40 per cent of total vehicle cost. This also reduces exposure to global supply chain volatility and pricing pressures from third-party suppliers.

The linkage to policy is direct. Under India's Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for Advanced Chemistry Cells, incentives are tied to local manufacturing of battery cells and a phased increase in domestic value addition. Without in-house cell production, Tata Motors would remain dependent on imports and struggle to meet these thresholds.

# Maruti Suzuki achieves highest-ever production of 23.4 lakh cars in FY26

**S Ronendra Singh**  
New Delhi

Maruti Suzuki India (MSIL) has achieved its highest-ever annual production volume of 23.4 lakh units in FY26.

This makes Maruti Suzuki the only original equipment manufacturer (OEM) in India to achieve such a record production volume of passenger vehicles, the company said.

In addition, it has also become the only company among Suzuki Motor Corporation's global automobile manufacturing facilities to achieve this landmark volume.

Dzire, Fronx, Swift, Ertiga and Baleno were the most produced models during the year, with each crossing the two-lakh unit mark, MSIL said.

**PROUD MOMENT**

“This is a proud moment for us, as very few companies across the world have been able to manufacture such large volumes in a single country. At Maruti Suzuki, we have always believed in offering products and technologies that complement the evolving needs and aspirations of our customers, earning their trust, generation after generation,” Hisashi Takeuchi, Managing Director and CEO, MSIL, said.

The achievement is the outcome of a carefully nurtured automobile ecosystem built over four and a half decades, he said, adding that the ecosystem is supported by the government's policy en-



vironment, like the rollout of GST 2.0, strengthened market confidence and stimulated demand at a critical time allowing us to manufacture record-high units.

“Our parent Suzuki Motor Corporation's strong belief in India's growth story, along with an increased focus on developing India as an export hub, is enabling us to further expand our production capacity. We aim to scale it to about 40 lakh units per annum,” Takeuchi added.

Maruti Suzuki currently operates four manufacturing facilities, one each in Gurugram, Manesar and Kharkhoda in Haryana, and Hansalpur in Gujarat. Together, these facilities have an installed annual capacity of 24 lakh units.

As part of its capacity expansion strategy, the company, in March 2026, identified land for its fifth manufacturing facility at Khoraj Industrial Estate in Sanand, Gujarat.

Once fully operational, this facility will have an annual production capacity of 10 lakh units. The company manufactures 17 models with over 650 variants for domestic and export market requirements.

VISUALLY.

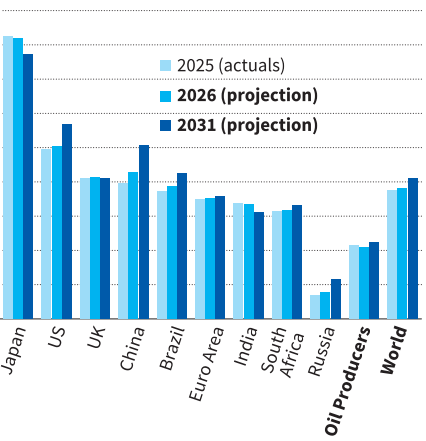
Compiled by **Sourashis Banerjee, Roshan Flavian** | Graphic: **Visveswaran V**

## Snowballing debt

Global public debt scenario has not improved in a meaningful way since Covid, and the recent conflict in West Asia has only added further fiscal pressure to an already strained global landscape. However, the conflict's fiscal impact is highly asymmetric. Energy-importing countries, particularly low-income developing countries, face the largest costs, while the pool of potential beneficiaries is narrower than in past energy shocks, as major Gulf exporters are themselves directly affected by the conflict. This leads to a potential snowballing of public debt across countries as per the IMF Fiscal Monitor April 2026 report.

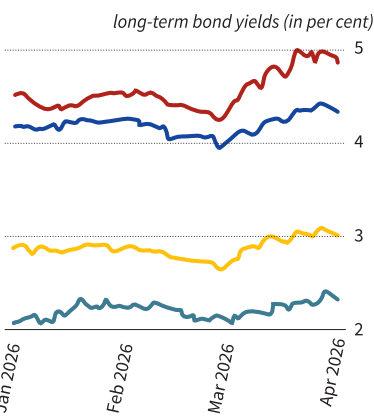
### Japan and US continue to run the highest gross government debt

General government gross debt, 2019–31 (in per cent of GDP)



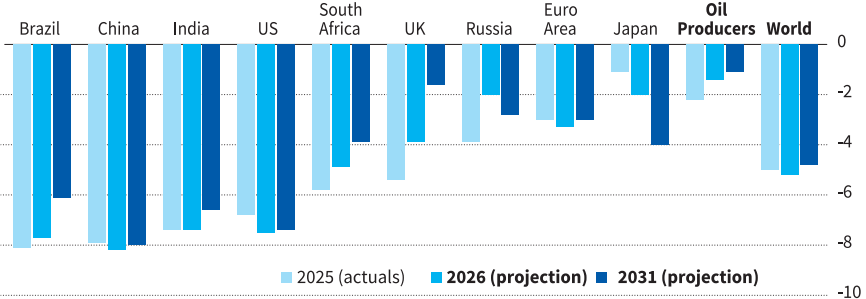
### Interest rates in advanced economies rise amid Iran war

UK (10-year) US (10-year) Germany (10-year) Japan (10-year)



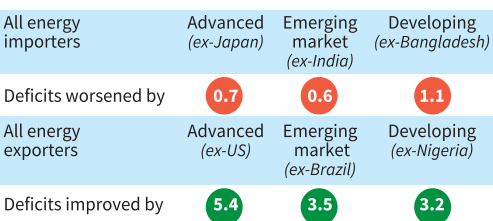
### India likely to run one of the highest deficit budgets in the near future, offset only by our high economic growth

General government fiscal balance, 2019–31 (in per cent of GDP)



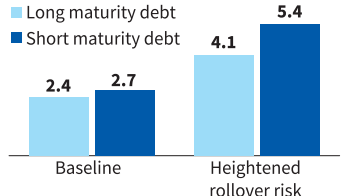
### Energy price boom due to war, has on average made fiscal deficit worse by 0.6 percentage points (pp) of GDP for countries like India, made it better by 5.4 pp of GDP for countries like the US

Average impact on government deficit during energy price booms, 1991–2025 (in percentage points of GDP)



### However, this time the US is also likely to suffer, as highly indebted countries are more susceptible to increase in cost of short-term borrowing

Change in the debt-to-GDP ratio one year after an increase in the cost of short-term borrowing (in pp)



## Tata Capital posts 43% jump in Q4 profit

**Press Trust of India**  
Mumbai

Non-bank lender Tata Capital on Thursday reported a 43 per cent jump in the March quarter net profit to ₹1,502 crore on a consolidated level and said it is exercising “extra diligence” while disbursing loans to MSMEs to manage risks associated with the West Asia crisis.

The company reported a net profit of ₹1,052 crore a year ago and ₹1,257 crore in the preceding September quarter.

The core net interest income came at ₹3,477 crore for the quarter, on the back of a 29 per cent growth in the assets under management to ₹86,653 crore and the net interest margin staying stable at 5.2 per cent.

Managing Director and Chief Executive Rajiv Sabharwal told reporters that the company is aiming for an expansion in the net interest margin (NIM) by focusing more on higher-yield-



ing products like retail unsecured and affordable housing.

Without sharing a loan growth target for FY27, he said that the company is sticking to its earlier aim of growing AUMs by 23–25 per cent every year till the end of FY28.

The continuing West Asia crisis will lead to extra diligence while disbursements to micro, small and medium enterprises, he said, adding that field teams are being specifically told to monitor working capital requirements and also availability of raw material.

Stating that the teams are doing weekly reviews of their exposure since the start of the crisis, Sabharwal said Tata Capital's clients seem to be in control of things till now from a raw material availability and supply chain resilience perspective.

Retail and MSME advances form 86 per cent of the AUM at present, and the same number may inch up in FY27 as it doubles down on products like affordable housing, he said.

**CREDIT COSTS**

Interestingly, he said Tata Capital was able to improve credit costs by 0.14 per cent due to conservative lending practices, which included deploying artificial intelligence tools as well.

He said the motor finance business acquired from the group company earlier in the fiscal year had turned around to deliver profits from the March quarter onwards, and added that only a fourth of its business now comes from Tata Motors' sales.

# Retail investors in Jaiprakash Associates to draw a blank after resolution approval

**Suresh P Iyengar**  
Mumbai

Retail investors of Jaiprakash Associates Ltd will be the final losers in the battle between Gautam Adani and Anil Agarwal to take control of the bankrupt company. The resolution plans of both Adani Enterprises and Vedanta have no provision to pay the 645,466 public shareholders. The

floating market-cap of ₹405 crore of JAL will be completely wiped-out after the resolution plan is approved.

The nine-year-old insolvency case has gone through many ups and downs with the committee of creditors initially announcing Vedanta's bid of ₹17,926 crore as the highest, but approving the ₹14,535 crore bid of Adani Enterprises.

NCLT then approved the Adani resolution plan. However, Vedanta moved NCLAT against NCLT. After hearing both companies, NCLAT reserved its judgement on Wednesday.

**NO RESIDUAL VALUE**

With creditors taking priority under IBC and recoveries falling short for secured lenders, no residual value remains for equity investors,

resulting in total erosion of shareholder wealth. Under resolution plans of both bidders, entire shareholding structure of JAL will be wiped out. Sunayana Basu Mallik, Partner, King Stubb & Kasiva, Advocates and Attorneys said, to enhance credibility among the public with respect to stock exchanges and listed companies, the government may consider framing binding regulations within the scheme of the IBC to refund the consideration received from the public equity shareholders before proceeding with the CIRP. The responsibility to make such payouts should vest in the resolution applicant and the CoC approving the plan, adding to the cost and overall burden of taking over a loss-making entity, he said.

# Classic Legends targets 2028 IPO, alongside global foray

**Amit Vijay Mohile**  
Mumbai

Classic Legends, the Mahindra-backed maker of Jawa, Yezdi and BSA motorcycles, is targeting a public listing by 2028, by which time Co-founder Anupam Thareja says the global expansion strategy will be sufficiently in place to justify raising capital.

The IPO is not positioned as an exit for the founders or investors, but as a funding instrument to scale internationally, taking BSA to Western markets, Jawa to Eastern Europe and South America, and Yezdi across India.

“There is no need right now,” Thareja told *businessline* at the launch of two new scramblers in Mumbai on Wednesday.

“When I go global in a very big way — which I will — I'll need a currency on the board

that I can leverage.” Thareja, who has taken 11 companies public, was deliberate in separating the listing rationale from any liquidity motive. The balance sheet is comfortable for a near-term strategy, with annual capex running at ₹300–500 crore.

**TWO LAUNCHES**

The two launches on Wednesday reflect the global architecture. Yezdi Scrambler, powered by a new liquid-cooled 350 cc engine named Katar and India's lightest scrambler at 174 kg, is priced from ₹1,99,950 — just below the ₹2 lakh threshold, where its primary competitors sit. BSA Scrambler 650, carrying India's only 650 cc single-cylinder engine in the segment and drawing design inspiration from the Gold Star Catalina and A10 Spitfire, starts at ₹3,24,950 and is scaled through a separate joint venture with Tube In-



**IN TOP GEAR.** The IPO is a funding instrument to scale internationally, taking BSA into Western markets, Jawa into Eastern Europe and South America, and Yezdi across India

vestments. “Scramblers are the SUVs of motorcycling,” Thareja said. “Built for confident city riding, but agile and rugged enough to inspire you to explore terrain beyond roads on the weekends.”

The three-brand architecture sits on a shared global platform: BSA as an authentically British marque for

Western markets, Jawa for Eastern Europe and Latin America, and Yezdi as the domestic flagship. “I will proudly sell this as Indians not being taken for granted anymore,” Thareja said. “The same platform, sold as Yezdi in India, BSA in London, and Jawa in Eastern Europe.”

Classic Legends sold around 57,000 motorcycles in FY26, nearly doubling from about 32,000 units in FY25, with profitability confirmed across every cash metric despite historic commodity cost pressures, especially aluminium. The company also carries no depreciation or interest burden on its manufacturing facility, acquired from the Mahindra group at no cost.

“The return on capital is going to be infinite,” Thareja said. The domestic market, however, remains structurally challenging. Classic Legends operates in India's mass-premium motorcycle segment, where Royal Enfield dominates with over 1.2 million motorcycles sold annually, accounting for more than 80 per cent of the core market. Classic Legends, with around 57,000 units sold, holds a roughly 5 per cent share of the segment.

QUICKLY.

Srikanth Velamakanni is  
new Nasscom Chairman



**New Delhi:** Nasscom has appointed Srikanth Velamakanni, Co-Founder and Group Chief Executive of Fractal, as its Chairperson, succeeding Sindhu Gangadharan, MD, SAP Labs India, who completes a distinguished term as Chairperson in April. Alongside this, the Nasscom Executive Council has also elected Kishor Patil, Co- Founder, CEO & MD at KPIT, as the new Vice-Chairperson. **OUR BUREAU**

**RBI imposes penalty on  
EbiX Payment, 2 others**

**Mumbai:** The Reserve Bank of India has imposed a penalty of ₹80,000 on EbiX Payment Services for non-compliance with certain directions, according to a release. The central bank also imposed ₹80,000 penalty on Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Nagari Sahakari Bank and ₹1 lakh on Hardoi Jilla Sahkari Bank. **PTI**

# War impact: RBI bulletin flags early signs of economic deceleration

**STATE OF ECONOMY.** Central bank also sees higher inflation risks from supply shocks

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

While the Indian economy continues to hold its ground despite facing a major supply shock due to the conflict in West Asia, early signs of deceleration are evident in select economic indicators such as port cargo, air passenger traffic and the outlook of purchasing managers, according to an article in RBI's latest monthly bulletin.

The "State of the Economy" article, put together by RBI officials, also underscored that though inflation remained contained within the tolerance band, upside risks had increased, driven by supply-side disruptions, including weather-related uncertainties.

Possible second round effects, with the supply shock transforming itself into demand shock, also warrant careful and continuous assessment, said the authors.

In March, available high-frequency indicators of economic activity displayed di-



**AREAS OF CONCERN.** Early deceleration signs have emerged in cargo and air traffic **REUTERS**

vergent trends: demand conditions remained resilient, despite some pockets of slowdown in economic momentum, per the article.

The central bank's forward looking surveys pointed towards softening consumer confidence on the current situation and moderation in business optimism along with build-up of cost pressures.

The authors said the manufacturing PMI (purchase managers' index), albeit in expansionary zone, declined to its lowest level in nearly four years. Cost pressures

and uncertainty took a toll on new orders and output, which grew at the slowest rates since mid-2022.

**SERVICES PMI**

The services PMI showed resilience, although its pace of expansion slowed to a 14-month low, reflecting softening in new business.

The index of eight core industries also declined, marking its 19-month low, driven by a decline in production of fertilizers, crude oil, coal, and electricity, the authors said.

The PMI data for March

revealed an intensification of input cost pressures across both manufacturing and services firms, the article said.

The increase in output prices, however, moderated for manufacturing firms, reflecting competition to retain customers and secure new clients, and a softer increase in new orders.

In contrast, prices charged by services firms continued to increase, aided by a near record expansion in international orders offsetting the domestic business slow down.

# Commercial LPG sales slump to a record low in March as imports dip

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**  
New Delhi

Liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) sales from the industrial and commercial segments declined to one of its lowest on record in March as the West Asia conflict choked imports of the commodity forcing the government to prioritise supply to households for cooking.

Sales from the LPG packed non-domestic segment fell by 48 per cent y-o-y and 59 per cent m-o-m to around 1.13 lakh tonnes on a provisional basis, data from Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell (PPAC) showed.

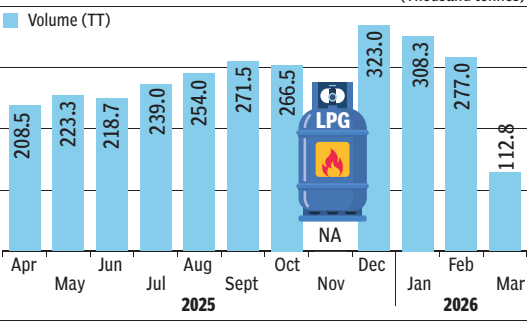
Similarly, the sale to LPG packaged domestic consumers, or simply households, fell by 8.1 per cent y-o-y and 7.8 per cent m-o-m to 25.78 lakh tonnes — the lowest in the last financial year.

**DOMESTIC CONSUMERS**

As of March, India has around 33.40 crore active domestic LPG consumers, of which more than 10.50 crore are PM Ujjwala Yojna (PNUY) beneficiaries. India also has over 25,600 distributors of the commodity.

The steep decline in sales

## War chokes LPG supply



from both the domestic and commercial sectors is on account of lower availability of the cooking fuel due to the West Asia conflict, which has led to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) — the main transit route for India's LPG imports.

The world's second largest LPG importer procures 60 per cent of its LPG and about 90 per cent of that normally transits the Strait of Hormuz.

When the route came under stress, monthly imports fell from 2.04 million tonnes (mt) in February 2026 to 1.12 mt in last month, a 45 per cent decline on a monthly basis.

The closure of the critical

energy choke point since February 28 severely impacted India's imports, which in normal times stood around 54,000 tonnes per day (TPD) and has come down to roughly 30,000 TPD.

The consumption of LPG by India, the world's third largest consumer, fell by almost 16 per cent m-o-m and 13 per cent y-o-y to 2.38 million tonnes (mt) on a provisional basis — the lowest in the last 21 months.

Meanwhile, at the inter-ministerial briefing on West Asia on Thursday, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Oil Ministry, said that LPG supply continues to be affected by the prevailing geopolitical situation.

# 'India-US trade talks are ongoing, constructive'

**Our Bureau**  
New Delhi

India on Thursday said the engagement between New Delhi and Washington on the trade deal is "ongoing and constructive" with both sides working towards a "mutually beneficial" agreement.

At the weekly media briefing, spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) Randhir Jaiswal underlined that the negotiations between the two countries is also focused on addressing "mutual concerns".



Randhir Jaiswal,  
spokesperson, Ministry of  
External Affairs

"Engagements are ongoing and constructive. Both sides are working towards a balanced, mutually beneficial and forward premium trade agreement that takes into account each

other's concerns and priorities and to reach a trade target of \$500 billion by 2030 so that is where we are on the welcome trade agreement," Jaiswal said.

This comes as the Indian team led by Darpan Jain, Additional Secretary in the Commerce Ministry, concluded its three-day visit to the US to fine tune the trade deal.

The Indian delegation engaged with officials from the US Trade Representative (USTR) office, which was led by Brendan Lynch, Assistant USTR for South and Central Asia.

# No proposal to hike retail prices of auto fuels, says govt

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**  
New Delhi

The government on Thursday reiterated that there is no proposal "under consideration" to raise retail prices of auto fuels even as the PSU oil marketing companies are bearing under recoveries of around ₹20 a litre on petrol and ₹100 on diesel.

India had a combined daily under-recovery of around ₹2,400 crore (till March 27), as per the Oil Ministry. Around March 27, at current international crude prices,

under-recoveries stood at approximately ₹26 per litre on petrol and ₹81.90 on diesel. While around April 2, there was an under recovery of ₹24.40 per litre on petrol and ₹104.99 on diesel.

According to Kotak Institutional Equities, relative to 11 months of FY26, the Indian crude basket rose by \$47 per barrel in March 2026 and \$53 in the first half of April. Despite a 13-15 per cent decline in imports, India's crude import bill has increased by \$190-210 million per day.

On raising petrol and

diesel prices after the State assembly elections, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Petroleum & natural Gas (MoPNG), said "There is no such proposal under consideration by the government."

"Under-recovery may be around ₹20 per litre on petrol and around ₹100 on diesel," she added.

Sharma emphasised that there is a "lot of volatility" in international crude oil prices. However, the government has not raised retail prices of auto fuels.

"If you look at crude bas-

ket, the oil we were purchasing for \$70 per barrel FY26 average), it has increased to an average of more than \$113 per barrel in this month (April 2026). If you look at the Indian basket from November 2021 to March 2026, there is a huge increase and in spite of that the government has not increased the price. Government's effort has been to keep prices stable," she added.

Sharma said that the government has not raised the retail prices of petrol and diesel since April 6, 2022.

India imports more than

88 per cent of its crude oil requirement, and higher oil prices coupled with a weak rupee will adversely impact its current account deficit. An increase of \$1 per barrel leads to an annual increase of roughly ₹16,000 crore in the import bill. Private refiners such as Nayara Energy and Shell have already raised fuel prices. The government has reduced the excise duty on petrol and diesel by ₹10 per litre, cutting the duty on petrol to ₹3 per litre and that on diesel to zero (from ₹10) to combat surging international crude oil prices.



# SASTRA

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Misreading markets

Primary market does not need special dispensation

A decline in stock prices since the start of this calendar year has impacted primary market fundraising. In the first quarter of 2026, average funds raised per month through initial public offerings on the mainboard of the exchanges was just ₹5,610 crore; this was against average monthly fundraising of ₹31,757 crore in the last quarter of 2025. Primary offerings on the SME platform mirror this trend. However, this is more in the nature of a welcome market correction.



Yet, the Securities and Exchange Board of India seems to have taken a different view. Perhaps persuaded by the impact of the Iran war on fund-raising, it has relaxed norms for companies making initial public offerings in the coming months. Primary markets — which typically go through phases when issuances flood the market, followed by those when offerings dry up — have been hyperactive and frothy over the last two years. These cycles are influenced by the requirements of the promoters, demand from investors and the valuations being given to issues by the market. The total number of IPOs on the mainboard and the SME platform were 375 and 336 in calendar year 2025 and 2024 respectively. This is more than twice the average of 126 IPOs per year in the preceding five years. Funds raised have also been quite high, around ₹1.9 lakh crore each in 2024 and 2025. With the market regulator clamping down on equity derivatives trading to check speculation, many retail investors seem to have shifted to primary markets. The share of IPO allocations to retail investors increased to 23 per cent in FY26 from 19 per cent in FY25. The share of institutional investors declined by 5 percentage points in this period. Primary issuances are risky for retail investors, since companies here usually do not have a known track record.

The current downtrend is not an adverse development. However, the Securities and Exchange Board of India has extended the deadline for making public offers — for companies whose deadline is set to expire between April and September this year. They now have time till end-September. The regulator will also allow companies to cut the size of the IPO by up to 50 per cent without having to follow onerous procedures. Small companies can perhaps weather serious global headwinds. Even so, SEBI's incentives seem overdone, if not a tad premature.

The quality of issuances in the primary market has suffered in the wake of speculative activity. Several scams surfaced on the SME platform in 2025 — promoters were found siphoning IPO proceeds, backing shell companies or manipulating stock prices to dump shares. The prevailing tepidity was therefore exactly what was needed. The regulator should, in fact, consider tightening regulations on disclosures, scrutiny of offer documents and curtailing speculation before and immediately after listing. A special dispensation for primary markets is not desirable.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

The predictable refuge of failing governments

The announcement of Peter Mandelson's appointment as US ambassador ensures that 20 December 2024 will be recorded as a fateful day in Sir Keir Starmer's leadership. Less remarked on, but relevant in hindsight, is a speech that the prime minister made earlier that month to launch a "plan for change". Sir Keir set out ambitions to improve public services and lamented caution in the civil service. Whitehall, he said, was too often comfortable "in the tepid bath of managed decline". The prime minister was feeling thwarted by the machinery of government. In that context, it is easy to see how he might have been persuaded that Lord Mandelson would make a better emissary to the US than the long-serving professional diplomat in post at the time. Impatience with a slow-moving apparatus is conveyed also in the account given by Sir Olly Robbins, the former permanent secretary at the Foreign Office. LONDON, APRIL 22

讀賣新聞

THE YOMIURI SHIMBUN

Lifting Blockades on Strait is Urgent for Negotiations

The two-week ceasefire agreed upon by the United States and Iran has been extended. While it was appropriate for the United States to refrain from resuming hostilities, there is no clear path forward for negotiations with Iran, and the situation seems to be in a deadlock. Both countries must stop engaging in unproductive maneuvering, lift the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz and work toward the complete cessation of hostilities through negotiations. U.S. President Donald Trump announced the extension of the ceasefire shortly before the deadline and did not specify a new deadline. The two countries had agreed to a ceasefire on April 7, with the deadline set for April 22. After the ceasefire took effect, the two countries held their first face-to-face talks in Islamabad, the capital of mediating nation Pakistan. TOKYO, APRIL 23

Spreads are crucial to oil prices

OIL DYNAMICS. If ceasefire holds, the Brent–WTI spread and the spot–futures gap should fall, easing Indian basket rates



V SHUNMUGAM

Headline crude prices draw the spotlight, but traders and treasuries have long understood that the real signal lies in the spreads. Two are flashing loudly right now: the Brent–WTI differential, and the gap between spot physical cargoes and the futures curve.

Together, they show how the 2026 Middle East disruption is reshaping a market whose underlying plumbing had spent a decade settling into a comfortable rhythm.

For most of the 2000s, West Texas Intermediate (WTI) and Brent crude prices moved in near lockstep. WTI, the lighter and sweeter grade, even traded at a small premium to Brent as late as 2009. At that time, the US was a net importer, Cushing, Oklahoma, was merely a pipeline crossroads, and the two benchmarks served as essentially two windows onto the same global price.

Shale fracking broke that symmetry. Starting around 2010, tight-oil production from the Bakken, Eagle Ford, and Permian surged into Cushing faster than pipelines could move those barrels south to Gulf Coast refineries. By late 2011, Brent was trading roughly \$25 above WTI — the widest dislocation most modern traders had ever seen.

The cause was not demand or geopolitics but geography: WTI had effectively become landlocked crude priced at a mid-continent storage hub, while Brent remained a seaborne benchmark connected to the rest of the world.

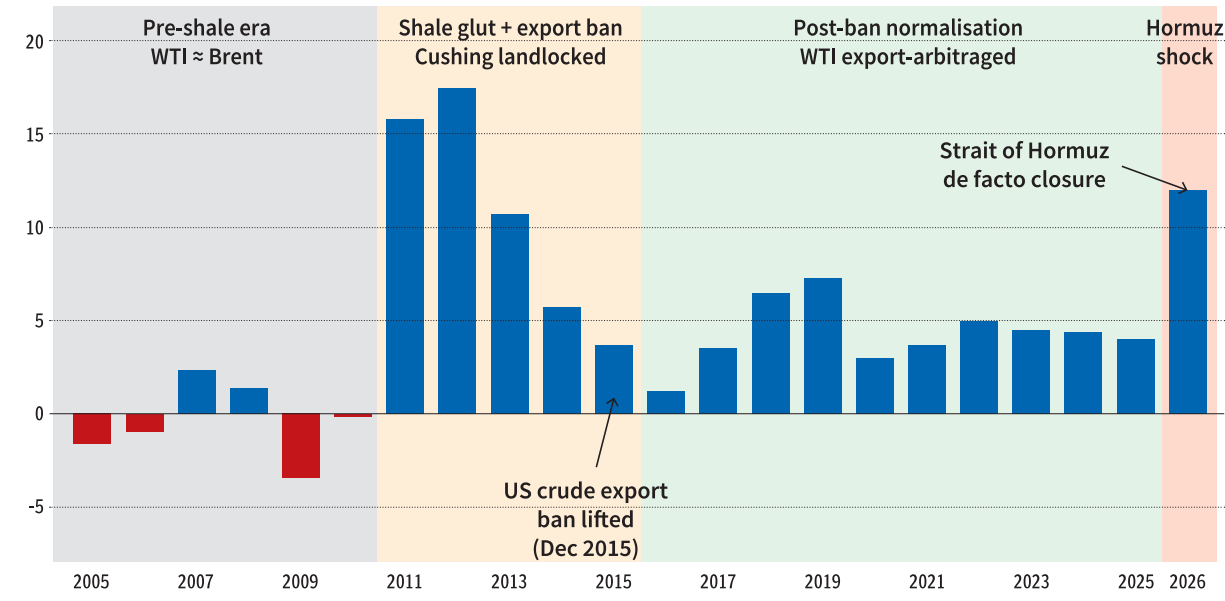
In December 2015, the US Congress ended the 40-year ban on oil exports, and the market gradually rebalanced. New pipelines to Corpus Christi and Houston, expanded dock capacity, and a steady stream of WTI cargoes to Asia and Europe pushed the Brent–WTI spread into a narrower \$3–\$7 range for most of the past decade. From there, the differential largely reflected a freight-and-quality relationship: Brent minus WTI approximated the cost of shipping a Gulf Coast barrel to a European refiner, with an adjustment for its quality premium.

COMPONENTS OF THE SPREAD

Strip away the noise and a few clear forces drive the Brent–WTI spread. Location and transport set a structural floor: Cushing is inland, and pipeline capacity to the Gulf determines how

The Brent–WTI spread through three regimes, 2005–2026

Brent minus WTI (\$/bbl, annual avg)



Sources: EIA STEO (April 2026), EIA Today in Energy, trade-press averages. 2026 figure is year-to-date through April

easily surplus US crude can reach seaborne buyers.

Layered on top are cyclical drivers — US production growth, Cushing inventories, available export capacity, and the geopolitical risk premium, which almost always hits Brent first because the Middle East sits at the other end of the supply chain. WTI's slight quality advantage pulls in the opposite direction, narrowing the spread.

The spread is so actively traded because it offers the cleanest way to express a view on US infrastructure relative to global risk. When the spread widens, it typically reflects one of two forces: either a US supply surge, or a global shock from which the US is comparatively insulated. In April 2026, the evidence points emphatically to the second scenario.

Following the late-February military action in the Gulf and the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz, Brent crude surged from about \$61 at the start of the year to \$118 by the end of March —

The Brent–WTI spread, which started the year near \$4 peaked at \$25 on March 31, and is expected by the EIA to average \$15 in April. The message from the market is clear: this disruption is primarily a Brent problem, not a WTI one

the largest inflation-adjusted quarterly move the EIA has recorded since 1988. WTI also rose, but far less, as high US inventories and the prospect of a Strategic Petroleum Reserve release capped its gains.

The Brent–WTI spread, which started the year near \$4, averaged \$11 in March, peaked at \$25 on March 31, and is expected by the EIA to average \$15 in April. The message from the market is clear: this disruption is primarily a Brent problem, not a WTI one.

Overlaid on that is a second, even more striking distortion: spot physical barrels are trading far above the futures curve. Dated Brent hit a record \$144 on April 7 while the Brent futures contract traded near \$109 — a gap of about \$35.

The WTI curve is also in steep backwardation, with prompt contracts at a double-digit premium to the following month and the back end of the curve priced in the high \$50s through the mid-2030s. The message is unambiguous: the long end says the market expects this to pass; the front end says the pain is far from over. Refiners are paying whatever it takes for a barrel they can load onto a tanker today.

IMPACT ON INDIA

India imports about 89 per cent of its crude oil, and the Indian Basket is its main real-time import price benchmark. Until February, the formula gave Dubai and Oman sour grades a 79 per cent weight and Brent just 21 per cent, even though Russian barrels (35–45 per cent) of India's imports are priced off Brent.

In March, the Petroleum Planning and

Analysis Cell unusually changed the formula mid-year, lifting Brent's weight to 69 per cent and cutting Dubai–Oman to 31 per cent. Brent now makes up more than two-thirds of the basket for the first time since before 2006.

The rebalancing is crucial: the basket jumped from about \$63 in January to around \$146 by mid-March — a larger move than Brent's own rally — because Dubai and Oman are priced mainly off spot assessments, not a deep futures market, and thus fully absorb the Hormuz premium. Of the three grades in the basket, only Brent has a liquid, hedgeable futures contract.

With Dubai and Oman priced mostly on the spot, Indian refiners — and therefore the sovereign — cannot effectively hedge most of their actual purchases. When the spot–futures dislocation widens, as it has now, the basket bears costs that paper markets consistently understate.

Raising the Brent weighting is a double-edged move. It better matches India's crude sourcing and expands hedgeable exposure, but also brings the global risk premium directly into the benchmark for fuel prices, subsidies, and the current account.

If a ceasefire holds and Hormuz normalises, both spreads should narrow by year-end. Otherwise, India will be paying full spot Gulf prices on much of its basket, with little room to hedge.

Headlines will keep highlighting \$100 oil, but the spreads tell a more important story.

The writer is Partner Consulting, MCQuibe

India-Korea: A services-led trade reset

The India-Korea Digital Bridge is an acknowledgement of India's growing strength in services exports

Ganesh Valiachi

The decision to resume negotiations on upgrading the India–South Korea Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement reflects a timely recognition: the existing trade model has reached its limits. Bilateral trade has grown to around \$27 billion, but the structure remains skewed.

India continues to run a merchandise trade deficit of \$10–12 billion, driven by imports of high-value manufactured goods such as electronics and machinery, while exports remain concentrated in lower-value segments. The new target of \$50 billion by 2030 is ambitious, but without a shift in composition, increased trade volume alone risks reinforcing this imbalance.

The significance of the CEPA upgrade, therefore, lies not in expanding trade *per se*, but in redefining what drives that trade.

INDIA'S SERVICES STRENGTH

What makes the current moment different is that policymakers are implicitly acknowledging India's real strength, services exports. India exported over \$340 billion in services in 2023–24, accounting for nearly 40 per cent of total exports, and generated a surplus exceeding \$150 billion. This

surplus has consistently offset deficits in merchandise trade at the macro level.

Yet, this advantage has not translated proportionately in India's trade with South Korea. Despite Korea's advanced digital economy and demand for high-end services, India's service presence in the Korean market remains limited. This is where the strategic shift becomes important. Unlike manufacturing, where India still faces scale and competitiveness constraints, the services sector has grown without heavy subsidies or incentives. Its expansion has been driven by capability, not protection.

The implication is clear: India does not need more incentives for services; it needs structured market access and strategic alignment. This is precisely what the current partnership is beginning to address.

RIGHT STRATEGIC BET

The announcement of the India–Korea Digital Bridge is not just an add-on — it is the most forward-looking element of the partnership, and arguably the most consequential. By focusing on AI, semiconductors, and digital technologies, both countries are aligning their core economic strengths.

India brings scale, talent, and a rapidly expanding digital ecosystem — with over 850 million internet users and a digital economy projected to reach \$1



INDIA-KOREA. Services push /ISTOCKPHOTO

trillion by 2030. South Korea contributes technological depth in semiconductors, electronics, and advanced manufacturing.

The critical point is that this collaboration is inherently services-led. Even in hardware-dominated sectors like semiconductors, the highest value segments, design, software integration, and AI optimisation, are service-intensive. Similarly, in manufacturing sectors such as shipbuilding, the integration of digital engineering and automation opens space for India's services sector.

In this sense, the Digital Bridge is not just about technology cooperation — it is a mechanism to embed Indian services into Korean industrial ecosystems. This is exactly the kind of strategic alignment

that can rebalance bilateral trade without relying on traditional tariff tools.

The CEPA upgrade must institutionalise this shift by incorporating digital trade frameworks, seamless cross-border data flows, easier mobility for skilled professionals, and mutual recognition of qualifications and standards.

If these elements are effectively integrated, India can significantly expand its footprint in Korea's services market, enabling services exports to offset merchandise deficits at the bilateral level, much like they already do at the global level. The broader significance of this partnership lies in its timing.

At a moment when global trade is being reshaped by technology and supply chain realignments, India and South Korea are choosing to move beyond conventional trade logic. They are not just trying to trade more — they are choosing to trade smarter.

In doing so, they acknowledge a fundamental reality: the future of India's export competitiveness lies in services, and strategic digital partnerships like this are the most effective way to unlock it.

The writer is an Assistant Professor at Symbiosis Institute of International Business (SIIB), Pune. Views expressed are personal

✉ LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859–860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Fuel price hike?

This refers to the news report 'No plan yet to raise petrol, diesel prices: Oil Ministry' (April 23). Notwithstanding the Oil Ministry's clarification of 'no proposal for a petrol and diesel price hike after April 29, the concluding day of the ongoing assembly polls, media speculation of a hike may come true.

With current stalemate in the Iran war, a fuel price hike cannot be ruled out. .

SK Gupta

New Delhi

Meaningful internships

This refers to 'Final year students can now apply under PMIS' (April 23). The PM Internship Scheme now includes final-year students, and it aims to improve job readiness. This move links academic learning with early industry exposure across sectors.

However, many internships still focus on routine tasks, so meaningful skill development often remains limited. Therefore, a structured model with clear goals and mentor review can improve outcomes. Internships should build real skills, so students

gain meaningful benefit.

S Balasubramanian

Villupuram, TN

IMF caution

Apologies the Editorial 'Major undercurrents' (April 23), the dichotomy of the US economy is glaring. With 126 per cent public debt, 7–8 per cent government deficit and supplier of world's primary currency and world's dollar reserves at \$13.44 trillion, it does not augur well to depend on US collaboration.

The Trump tariffs and West Asian

turbulence have changed the world order for the worse. The IMF must suggest the solutions.

Vinod Johri

Delhi

Need for hybrid model

Apologies "Importance of Insurance Agents" (April 26), life insurance has always been a supply-push product, with agents as its foundation. They create demand, build trust, and guide families through complex decisions — roles digital platforms cannot replace.

The future, however, is not agents

versus digital, but agents with digital. Tomorrow's agents will be financial coaches and community advisors, equipped with dashboards and mobile tools to combine speed with human connection. Digital platforms will handle lead generation and onboarding; agents will focus on advisory and claims support. The winning strategy is clear: empower agents with digital tools. Insurers that blend technology with human touch will outperform those relying solely on either channel.

Roy Markose

Thiruvananthapuram





QUICKLY.

Cyient board okays ₹720-cr buyback issue



**Hyderabad:** The board of directors of Cyient Ltd have approved a ₹720 crore share buyback at ₹1,125 per share. “The board felt that the intrinsic value of the company’s business fundamentals is not reflected in the current market price. Hence approved the buyback proposal. We are confident that we will have strong cash flow to invest in future growth,” Krishna Bodanapu, Executive Vice Chairman and MD, Cyient, said. During Q4, which ended March 31, Cyient DET posted a net profit of ₹138 crore, reflecting a 9.1 per cent decline from the same period last year. It reported revenue of ₹1,500 crore for the quarter, up by 7.4 per cent from the comparable quarter last year. **OUR BUREAU**

Muthoot Fincorp rolls out NCD issue eyeing ₹600 cr

**Kochi:** Muthoot FinCorp Ltd launched NCD Tranche III of secured and redeemable non-convertible debentures with a face value of ₹1,000 each, scheduled for issuance on April 24. The net proceeds will be used for onward lending, financing and repayment/ prepayment of interest and principal of existing borrowings, and for corporate purposes. It aims to raise up to ₹600 crore within the approved shelf limit of ₹3,000 crore. The issue comprises a base size of ₹200 crore with a green shoe option of ₹400 crore, aggregating up to ₹600 crore. The NCDs offer annual yields ranging from 8.84 to 9.25 per cent across tenure options of 24, 36, 60, and 72 months. It will be open to the public till May 8. **OUR BUREAU**

Sensex, Nifty tumble as crude crosses \$103, ₹ hits April low

**NO RESPITE.** Nifty Midcap 100 slips 0.41% and Nifty Smallcap 100 edges down 0.67%

Anupama Ghosh  
Mumbai

The markets extended their losing streak into a second straight session on Thursday, with the BSE Sensex shedding 852 points to close at 77,664 and the Nifty 50 falling 205 points to settle at 24,173 — as Brent crude surged to \$103.38 per barrel, marking its fourth consecutive session of gains. Besides, the rupee weakened for a fourth straight session, slipping 32-34 paise to around 94.12 against the dollar.

The sell-off was broad and unrelenting. The Sensex opened gap-down, briefly recovered to 78,178, then surrendered to a low of 77,574, before closing near the day’s bottom. The Nifty followed an identical script, finally



**CAUTIOUS TONE.** The near-term outlook remains cautiously negative to neutral, with increased volatility expected due to global uncertainties, say analysts

ending 205.05 points or 0.84 per cent lower at 24,173.05 . **SELL ON RISE?** The near-term outlook remains cautiously negative to neutral, with increased volatility expected due to global uncertainties, while any bounce may face resistance unless supported by strong follow-through buying, said Hitesh Tailor, Technical Research Analyst at Choice Equity Broking. The primary trigger was geopolitical. WTI crude climbed above \$94 per barrel for a fourth straight session as US-Iran diplomatic efforts showed little progress, with Tehran asserting control over the Strait of Hormuz. Sectorally, Auto and PSU

Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC Q4 profit down 18% at ₹187 cr on lower income

Our Bureau  
Mumbai



A Balasubramanian, MD and CEO, Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC

Aditya Birla Sun Life Asset Management Company’s net profit in the March quarter fell 18 per cent to ₹187 crore compared to ₹228 crore logged in the same period last year, due to a decline in other income that dragged down total income.

Revenue from operations increased 7 per cent to ₹458 crore (₹428 crore), but overall income fell 15 per cent to ₹425 crore (₹501 crore) as there was a net loss of ₹33 crore in other income, against ₹72 crore earned last year.

The AMC has declared a di-

vidend of ₹25.50 per share.

The quarterly average assets under management increased 14 per cent to ₹4.36 lakh crore (₹3.82 lakh crore) in the quarter under review.

Despite market turbulence, equity assets were up 17 per cent at ₹1.97 lakh crore

(₹1.69 lakh crore), while that of fixed income was up 12 per cent at ₹2.38 lakh crore.

SIP SURGE

The SIP contribution increased to ₹1,204 crore (₹1,169 crore) as new SIP registrations jumped to 61,700 (54,300). However, contributing SIP accounts were down at 4.05 million (4.20 million).

In the financial year ended March, the fund house registered a 5 per cent increase in net profit at ₹975 crore (₹931 crore), while revenue was up nine per cent at ₹1,845 crore (₹1,685 crore).

Overall income jumped 4 per cent to ₹2,059 crore (₹1,986 crore).

UTI AMC incurs ₹51 crore net loss in Q4

Our Bureau  
Mumbai

UTI Asset Management Company reported a net loss of ₹51 crore in the March quarter against a profit of ₹102 crore logged in the same period last year.

Revenue increased 4 per cent to ₹390 crore (₹376 crore). Total income was up at ₹402 crore (₹376 crore), including other income of ₹12 crore.

TO PAY ₹40/SHARE

The fund house has announced a dividend of ₹40. It has incurred an expense of ₹175 crore on net loss on fair value. The assets under management of the mutual fund business increased 14 per

HSBC downgrades India to ‘underweight’ on inflation and demand concerns

Madhu Balaji  
Bengaluru

Global banking major HSBC has downgraded India’s equity market rating to “underweight” from “neutral”, flagging concerns over rising inflation and weakening domestic demand that could impact corporate earnings growth. The brokerage said current consensus expectations of around 16 per cent year-on-year earnings growth for 2026 are likely to be revised downward as macroeconomic headwinds intensify. India’s heavy reliance on imported energy leaves it exposed to elevated global oil and gas prices, which could push up costs across sectors and erode profitability.

HSBC noted that higher energy prices may soon translate into increased fuel costs for consumers,

especially after the conclusion of the State elections. This, in turn, could trigger a fresh rise in inflation, undermining consumption demand and slowing the broader economic recovery.

The report also warned that inflationary pressures could spill over into the financial sector, with a potential rise in non-performing loans as borrowers face tighter conditions. Such developments would pose downside risks to corporate earnings and financial stability.

Although equity valuations in India have corrected from earlier highs, HSBC cautioned that they may appear expensive again as earnings downgrades begin to reflect in market expectations. Without a strong cyclical recovery, valuations could remain a constraint on fur-

ther market upside.

VOLATILITY FEARS

Foreign investor sentiment towards India remains cautious amid concerns over growth, currency volatility and global uncertainty. The rupee (₹) is seen as vulnerable to depreciation if oil prices stay elevated, which could further dampen foreign inflows and returns.

HSBC also highlighted that investors are increasingly assessing the impact of artificial intelligence on India’s key software services sector, adding another layer of uncertainty to the outlook.

Despite the downgrade, the brokerage maintained that selective opportunities remain in sectors such as private banking, base metals and healthcare, even as the broader market outlook turns cautious.



**GROWTH SHOW.** Assets under management of the mutual fund business increased 14% y-o-y to ₹3.88 lakh crore

moved up 17 per cent to ₹852 crore (₹731 crore) even as AUM increased 6 per cent to ₹39,813 crore.

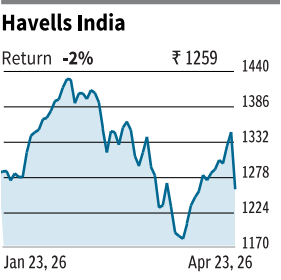
DIGITAL FOCUS

Vetri Subramaniam, MD and CEO, UTI AMC, said to improve investor experience and operational efficiency, the fund house has strengthened distribution capabilities, improved product offerings and made significant investments in technology and digital transformation over the past year.

“Our strategic priorities continue to be sustainable growth, increased market penetration, and maintaining strong cost discipline while leveraging the scale and strength of our platform,” he added.

Havells drops 6.5% post Q4, brokerages remain bullish but flag demand concerns

Our Bureau  
Bengaluru



Shares of Havells India fell sharply on Wednesday, declining 6.5 per cent on the NSE to ₹1,260.30 after the company reported a mixed set of fourth-quarter earnings, with subdued revenue growth and weak segmental performance weighing on investor sentiment.

Havells reported a standalone net profit of ₹734.24 crore for the quarter ended March 2026, up 40.5 per cent y-o-y from ₹522.26 crore.

Several brokerages, though maintained their bullish stance, pointed to weaker-than-expected EBITDA performance and soft demand in consumer-facing segments, particularly the Lloyd business, which saw a sharp decline.

CLSA maintained an ‘Outperform’ rating with a target price of ₹1,535 but noted that the company reported weak

fourth-quarter results, with EBITDA declining 6 per cent y-o-y and revenue growth of just 2 per cent.

HSBC retained a ‘Buy’ rating but cut its target price to ₹1,560, calling the quarter “unimpressive.” It highlighted that Lloyd’s revenue fell 19 per cent year-on-year, dragging overall performance, even as cables and wires and solar segments showed strong growth. Nomura also reiterated a ‘Buy’ rating with a target of ₹1,620, stating that while the fourth quarter was ahead of expectations in some areas, it has trimmed revenue and margin estimates due to

cost pressures. Macquarie, which has an ‘Outperform’ rating and a target of ₹1,588, described the quarter as good on margins but warned of demand risks stemming from macroeconomic uncertainty, including geopolitical tensions in the Middle East. It

CAUTIOUS TONES

Jefferies took a cautious stance, maintaining a ‘Hold’ rating with a target price of ₹1,290. It noted that while cables and wires remained a bright spot, weakness in consumer products and continued losses in the Lloyd segment weighed on overall performance.

Citi also maintained a ‘Neutral’ stance, cutting its target price to ₹1,500 from ₹1,600, citing “more misses than hits” in the quarter.

It flagged rising competition in the cables and wires segment and said sustained growth and margin improvement would be critical for any re-rating.

Maharashtra state electricity distributor preparing for IPO

Bloomberg

Maharashtra, India’s richest State, has begun preparations for an initial public offering (IPO) of its power distribution utility, according to people familiar with the matter.

Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company is working with SBI Capital and Deloitte on the proposed share sale that could raise between \$500 million and \$1 billion, the people said, asking not to be identified as the information is private.

SBI Capital and Deloitte are reviewing the company’s structure and balance sheet and will advise on IPO readiness, the people said. Once the framework is finalised, the company is expected to issue a request for proposals to appoint additional advisers and law firms, they added. The offering could include a mix of fresh shares and a stake sale, with a po-

tential dilution of about 10 per cent by State-governed MSEB holding company, the people said.

Deliberations are ongoing, and key details such as the size and timing of the offering are under discussion and could change, the people said. Representatives for MSEDCIL, SBI Capital and Deloitte didn’t respond to requests for comments.

CABINET NOD

The State’s cabinet of ministers has approved a revamp of the company, including a plan for the government to take over about ₹33,000 crore (\$3.5 billion) of the utility’s liabilities, a move intended to strengthen its balance sheet before the IPO.

The company has started the process of splitting off its agriculture business, according to Managing Director Lokesh Chandra. He declined to comment on the specifics of the IPO plan on the record.

Amba Auto Sales to raise ₹65 cr via IPO on NSE Emerge

Our Bureau  
Mumbai

Amba Auto Sales and Services, an automobile and consumer electronics retailer, plans to raise ₹65 crore through an initial public offering (IPO) on NSE Emerge.

The company will offer 48.24 lakh equity shares at a price band of ₹130-₹135 a share.

CAPEX PUSH

The issue will open for subscription on Monday.

The net proceeds from the IPO will be used to set up new showrooms and renovate existing ones, to meet the working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

CapitalSquare Advisors has been appointed as the book-running lead manager, while Bighshare Services will be the registrar to the issue.

BROKER’S CALL.

InCred Equities

TECHNO ELECTRIC & ENGG (BUY)

Target: ₹1,681  
CMP: ₹1,248.70  
Techno Electric & Engineering Company is a leading EPC player in India’s power transmission and distribution (T&D) sector with over 45 years of experience, with a pivotal role in executing NTPC’s first power station at Shaktinagar and constructing more than 50 per cent of Power Grid Corporation of India’s substations (over 160 out of 276), while also participating in nearly all NTPC power station projects.

The company has further expanded into tariff-based competitive bidding (TBCB) projects and signed an MoU with IndiGrid for asset monetisation, alongside diversifying into advanced smart metering (AMI) with contracts exceeding ₹2,600 crore, and entering the fast-growing data centre sector in 2021 with a planned investment of about \$1 billion to build 250 MW capacity by FY30; currently, the company has a strong order book of over ₹9,500 crore, indicating a book-to-bill ratio of about 3x, and is expected to deliver robust growth with revenue and EBITDA projected to grow at a 32 per cent CAGR to ₹5,177 crore by FY28E, while PAT is estimated to grow at 19 per cent CAGR moderated by higher depreciation. We value Techno Electric on an SOTP basis, and initiate coverage with a Buy at a Target Price of ₹1,681 (about 34 per cent upside from the CMP of ₹1,250), implying a P/E of 30x on FY28E earnings. Each business vertical has been valued separately.

IDBI Capital

L&T TECHNOLOGY SERVICES (HOLD)

Target: ₹3,765  
CMP: ₹3,449.10  
L&T Technology Services (LTTS) reported Q4FY26 revenue of \$306 million, down 1.7 per cent quarter on quarter but up 0.3 per cent year on year from continuing operations, reflecting deliberate portfolio rationalisation, including divestment of Smart World Cities (SWC), the loss-making business and exit from \$19 million annualised low-margin contracts in Europe and West Asia. EBIT margin expanded 40 bps sequentially to 15.2 per cent, marking the second consecutive quarter of margin improvement, reflecting better revenue quality and operational discipline. The management advanced its margin aspiration, now targeting mid-16 per cent by Q4FY27 or earlier, supported by SWC exit, rupee depreciation tailwind and AI-led delivery efficiencies. Full-year FY26 continuing operations revenue stood at \$1.23 billion, growing 8.3 per cent year on year. Large-deal TCV for the year stood at \$855 million, up 40 per cent. DSO improved sharply to 83 days in Q4, with the management guiding for a steady-state range of 85-90 days going forward, a significant improvement from the 110-115 days seen when SWC was included. Under its Lakshya 2031 plan, LTTS targets a 13-15 per cent dollar revenue CAGR over five years with 16-17 per cent EBIT margins, aspiring to reach mid-16 per cent margins by Q4FY27, underpinned by six technology bets. We maintain a HOLD rating with a revised TP of ₹3,765 and valuing the stock at 23.3x FY28E EPS.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: [blmarketwatch@gmail.com](mailto:blmarketwatch@gmail.com)

TODAY’S PICK.

Marico (₹778.95): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu  
bl. research bureau

The stock of Marico has been in a long-term uptrend.

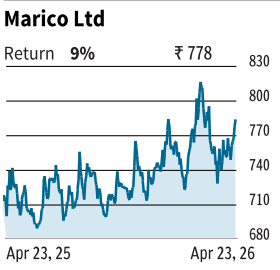
But after marking a high of ₹813.10 on February 24, the price dropped.

However, it found support at ₹725 and rebounded on the back of this in early April.

This week, it broke out of a key resistance at ₹765, indicating that the stock has resumed its uptrend after a corrective decline.

We expect the stock to establish a fresh leg of rally and rise to ₹850 in the near term. T

herefore, traders can buy the stock now at ₹778 and accumulate if the price drops to



**₹765. Keep stop-loss at ₹745. When the stock touches ₹815, revise the stop-loss to ₹785. Raise the stop-loss further to ₹815 when the price hits ₹835. Book profits at ₹850.**  
  
Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Day trading guide

| 24166 » Nifty 50 Futures |       |       |       |                                                                 |  |
|--------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1                       | S2    | R1    | R2    | COMMENT                                                         |  |
| 24100                    | 24000 | 24300 | 24600 | Buy the contract if it surpasses 24300; stop-loss can be 24150. |  |

| ₹784 » HDFC Bank |     |     |     |                                                               |  |
|------------------|-----|-----|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1               | S2  | R1  | R2  | COMMENT                                                       |  |
| 780              | 760 | 800 | 815 | Trading near a key moving average; buy with stop-loss at 760. |  |

| ₹1242 » Infosys |      |      |      |                                                                 |  |
|-----------------|------|------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1              | S2   | R1   | R2   | COMMENT                                                         |  |
| 1220            | 1200 | 1275 | 1300 | Go long if the stock rebounds from 1220; stop-loss can be 1200. |  |

| ₹305 » ITC |     |     |     |                                                                  |  |
|------------|-----|-----|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1         | S2  | R1  | R2  | COMMENT                                                          |  |
| 304        | 298 | 310 | 315 | Buy the stock as it is near a support; place a stop-loss at 298. |  |

| ₹286 » ONGC |     |     |     |                                                               |  |
|-------------|-----|-----|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1          | S2  | R1  | R2  | COMMENT                                                       |  |
| 282         | 276 | 292 | 295 | The stock is charting a sideways trend; refrain from trading. |  |

| ₹1343 » Reliance Ind. |      |      |      |                                                                |  |
|-----------------------|------|------|------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1                    | S2   | R1   | R2   | COMMENT                                                        |  |
| 1340                  | 1310 | 1350 | 1370 | Go short if the stock slips below 1340; stop-loss can be 1360. |  |

| ₹1094 » SBI |      |      |      |                                                                   |  |
|-------------|------|------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1          | S2   | R1   | R2   | COMMENT                                                           |  |
| 1085        | 1060 | 1115 | 1150 | The price action shows positive bias; buy with stop-loss at 1075. |  |

| ₹2522 » TCS |      |      |      |                                                                 |  |
|-------------|------|------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| S1          | S2   | R1   | R2   | COMMENT                                                         |  |
| 2500        | 2450 | 2560 | 2615 | Go long if the stock rebounds from 2500; stop-loss can be 2450. |  |

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

| Nifty 50 Movers             |          |        |         |       | ▼ 205.05 pts. |
|-----------------------------|----------|--------|---------|-------|---------------|
|                             | Close(F) | Pts    | PE      | WN(%) |               |
| Dr Reddys Lab               | 1331.00  | 15.16  | 20.11   | 0.73  |               |
| Cipla                       | 1305.90  | 8.54   | 23.27   | 0.66  |               |
| L&I                         | 4054.10  | 8.45   | 29.39   | 4.30  |               |
| Bharti Airtel               | 1841.20  | 8.17   | 30.28   | 5.10  |               |
| Jio Financial Services Ltd. | 248.66   | 7.26   | 101.21  | 0.74  |               |
| Coal India                  | 450.65   | 3.22   | 9.33    | 0.92  |               |
| Apollo Hosp                 | 7781.00  | 2.67   | 59.96   | 0.72  |               |
| Sun Pharma                  | 1680.10  | 2.38   | 36.80   | 1.61  |               |
| Adani Ports                 | 1602.90  | 2.30   | 29.55   | 1.07  |               |
| NestleIndia                 | 1416.50  | 2.30   | 77.73   | 0.51  |               |
| Adani Enter                 | 2300.00  | 2.23   | 18.78   | 0.54  |               |
| ONGC                        | 286.25   | 2.20   | 8.01    | 1.00  |               |
| Bharat Elec                 | 449.95   | 0.98   | 55.16   | 1.45  |               |
| TataConsumerProduct         | 1184.40  | 0.82   | 79.65   | 0.70  |               |
| Hindalco                    | 1041.35  | 0.46   | 14.55   | 1.36  |               |
| Max Healthcare              | 1006.75  | 0.23   | 69.03   | 0.68  |               |
| Titan                       | 4456.50  | 0.17   | 83.01   | 1.66  |               |
| ITC                         | 305.30   | -0.42  | 18.48   | 2.66  |               |
| Hind Unilever               | 2366.40  | -0.46  | 55.30   | 1.90  |               |
| PowerGrid Corp              | 319.15   | -0.59  | 19.12   | 1.30  |               |
| UltraTech Cement            | 12167.00 | -0.67  | 46.79   | 1.30  |               |
| Wipro                       | 202.76   | -0.77  | 16.03   | 0.52  |               |
| Bajaj Auto                  | 9550.50  | -1.24  | 30.05   | 0.96  |               |
| HDFC Life                   | 598.65   | -1.27  | 68.33   | 0.58  |               |
| J&W Steel                   | 1257.00  | -1.31  | 39.58   | 1.06  |               |
| HCL Tech                    | 1277.60  | -1.77  | 20.82   | 1.22  |               |
| NTPC                        | 402.25   | -3.26  | 15.71   | 1.72  |               |
| Grasim Ind                  | 2735.00  | -3.46  | 19.65   | 0.94  |               |
| TCS                         | 259.80   | -3.72  | 18.45   | 2.32  |               |
| Tata Steel                  | 210.91   | -3.82  | 28.86   | 1.57  |               |
| Asian Paints                | 2521.40  | -4.09  | 61.85   | 1.03  |               |
| Eicher Motors               | 7092.50  | -4.13  | 36.32   | 0.80  |               |
| Int'lGlobeAvi               | 4556.00  | -4.19  | 54.86   | 0.93  |               |
| State Bank                  | 351.95   | -4.52  | 47.86   | 0.67  |               |
| Eternal Ltd.                | 259.92   | -4.82  | 1085.85 | 1.69  |               |
| Maruti Suzuki               | 13160.00 | -5.07  | 27.71   | 1.56  |               |
| SBI Life                    | 1828.10  | -5.56  | 73.96   | 0.74  |               |
| Tech Mahindra               | 1421.50  | -5.69  | 30.34   | 0.81  |               |
| Axis Bank                   | 1369.60  | -6.26  | 16.11   | 3.55  |               |
| Bajaj Finserv               | 1792.60  | -6.33  | 14.94   | 0.93  |               |
| State Bank                  | 1094.25  | -8.19  | 11.67   | 4.10  |               |
| Trent Ltd.                  | 4251.40  | -8.36  | 93.30   | 0.85  |               |
| Bajaj Finance               | 918.35   | -9.57  | 31.18   | 2.22  |               |
| Kotak Bank                  | 370.40   | -10.36 | 19.60   | 2.46  |               |
| Shriram Finance Ltd.        | 1009.30  | -10.77 | 20.76   | 1.28  |               |
| M&M                         | 3047.70  | -19.89 | 22.42   | 2.46  |               |
| Infosys                     | 1240.60  | -21.42 | 17.97   | 3.93  |               |
| Reliance Ind                | 1343.40  | -27.56 | 18.59   | 8.19  |               |
| ICICI Bank                  | 1348.00  | -30.52 | 16.66   | 8.70  |               |
| HDFC Bank                   | 784.35   | -51.92 | 15.24   | 10.83 |               |



**Mumbai:** Japanese insurer Nippon Life's Indian asset management unit will pay a fine to settle allegations by Indian regulators that the fund fraudulently invested in bonds from lender Yes Bank, according to a document reviewed by *Reuters*. Nippon Life India Asset Management will pay \$10.25 million to settle charges it offered its customers high-risk Yes Bank bonds. **REUTERS**

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

In the reporting quarter, the bank's net interest income (NII) (difference between interest earned and interest expended) was marginally lower at ₹9,406 crore (₹9,514 crore in the year-ago period). Other income, including

|                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Asheesh Pandey, MD & CEO, noted that the bank shed bulk term deposits aggregating about ₹70,000 crore during the reporting | With credit growth outpacing deposit growth, the bank added bulk term deposits aggregating ₹22,904 crore in the reporting quarter. |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

With credit growth outpacing deposit growth, the bank added bulk term deposits aggregating ₹22,904 crore in the reporting quarter.

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

**Suresh P Iyengar**  
**T E Raja Simhan**  
Mumbai/Chennai



In a bid to retain buyers, Rajagopal said few exporters had borne the burden of duty by offering deep discounts. With duty refunds announced, the moot point is whether the buyer will part with duty refund with the exporters.

# FM, bank heads discuss Mythos threat

**MIXED BAG.** Anthropic’s AI model seen as a risk and opportunity for fintech ecosystem

**Our Bureau**  
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Thursday met bank chiefs to discuss risks related to artificial intelligence (AI) following global concerns over Anthropic’s Mythos model threatening the data security of financial systems.

Meanwhile, Finance Services Secretary M Nagaraju said Anthropic’s Mythos is seen both as risk and opportunity for the fintech ecosystem.

According to sources, the meeting chaired by the Finance Minister deliberated on various risks that AI posed to the financial sector. Banks have been urged to take pre-emptive measures to secure their systems, data and the money of customers.

Sources also said the Ministry and the RBI are studying the extent of risks that the Indian financial sector faces from this breach.

**CYBER-SECURITY TASKS**  
As per the reports, Anthropic said Mythos can outperform humans at cyber-security tasks, finding and exploiting thousands of bugs, including 27-year-old vulnerabilities, in major operating systems and web browsers. The US-based artificial intelligence company said unauthorised access was made on its new



**POLICY REVIEW.** The Finance Minister deliberated on various risks that AI posed to the financial sector

model Mythos, which is deemed too dangerous for public release.

Announced on April 7, Mythos is being deployed as part of Anthropic’s ‘Project Glasswing’, a controlled initiative under which select organisations are permitted to use the unreleased Claude Mythos Preview model for defensive cybersecurity.

Mythos is a powerful AI model that has sparked concerns among regulators about its unprecedented ability to identify digital security vulnerabilities and potential for misuse.

Meanwhile, addressing the PICUP Fintech Conference organised by the Indian Banks’ Association (IBA) in association with FICCI, Nagaraju said technology will play an important role

not only in driving innovation but also in strengthening supervision, risk management and fraud prevention. “AI has potential to make financial inclusion not just socially desirable but commercially sustainable. AI must be seen not just as a disruptor but as an enabler of responsible inclusion. Cyber security threats, data privacy concerns, credit and asset quality risk, trust deficit are some challenges which need to be managed to sustain long-term growth,” he added.

Speaking on the importance of UPI, Nagaraju said that around 22 billion transactions were made last month, with total value surpassing ₹29 lakh crore. “UPI has emerged as the largest real time retail payment sys-

tem in the world. India’s digital payment system is now expanding beyond our borders. UPI is operational in many countries and several more are in pipeline. This scale reflects not just widespread adoption but the emergence of UPI as a foundation pillar of India’s digital economy and financial inclusion,” he said.

### CRUCIAL ROLE

According to the Secretary, expanding access to credit responsibly and efficiently will be crucial for unlocking entrepreneurship and economic potential at the grassroots level.

“As we deepen capital and expand access, it is important to ensure that our financial system remains resilient and stable. A strong financial system must be capable of supporting growth during favourable times, while also withstanding shocks during periods of uncertainty,” he said.

# Anil Ambani proposes lenders’ panel to resolve dues, seeks Finance Minister’s intervention

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

Anil Ambani, Chairman and CEO of the Reliance Group, has written to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, seeking the constitution of a lenders’ committee, led by the State Bank of India and Bank of Baroda, to determine outstanding dues and devise a structured repayment plan, amid mounting legal and regulatory pressures on his group.

In a letter dated March 17, Ambani said the proposed panel would help “crystallise legally outstanding dues” and bring clarity to obliga-



Anil Ambani

ate, noting that actions over the past several months, including multiple FIRs, arrests and provisional attachment of assets worth over ₹15,000 crore, had severely constrained operations.

He added that freezing of bank accounts and credit lines had “effectively locked up liquidity,” paralysing businesses and eroding investor value. Ambani said the developments had resulted in a loss of more than ₹25,000 crore in market capitalisation, affecting over 5 million retail shareholders.

He pointed out that the situation is “at its core, a pure commercial matter between lenders and bor-

rowers” and called for a structured resolution mechanism rather than enforcement-led action.

### COUNTERAFFIDAVIT

The letter also referenced a counter affidavit filed before the Supreme Court on behalf of group firms, including Reliance Infrastructure and Reliance Power, where Ambani has sought the formation of a high-power committee to examine the issues.

The proposed lenders’ committee, he said, would provide a transparent framework for debt resolution, restore confidence among stakeholders and enable revival of business operations.

# Start-up GalaxEye to launch ‘world’s first’ OptoSAR l in three months

**Aishwarya Kumar**  
Bengaluru

Bengaluru-based space-tech start-up GalaxEye is set to launch its first satellite, Mission Drishti, within the next three months, marking a significant step in India’s emerging private space ecosystem.

The mission will introduce what it claims is the world’s first “OptoSAR” platform.

The satellite combines optical and synthetic aperture radar (SAR) sensors to deliver consistent, high-resolution imagery, even through clouds and in darkness, addressing a key gap in earth observation.

The multi-sensor Earth observation satellite, with a launch weight of approxi-

mately 180-190 kg with 1–1.5 m resolution, marks a new imaging category.

### CORE INNOVATION

The company aims to scale to a 10–20 satellite constellation by 2029, with growth driven by global data sales through channel partners across defence, climate and commercial use cases.

The core innovation lies in synchronising optical and SAR sensors on a single platform, an engineering challenge that has traditionally limited their combined use, explained Suyash Singh, CEO and Co-Founder of GalaxEye.

### OPTICAL IMAGING

While optical imaging provides intuitive, high-resolution visuals, it is constrained by cloud cover and

lighting conditions. SAR, on the other hand, can capture data through clouds and in darkness but is harder to interpret, Singh added.

To achieve this, the company has built a system that captures optical and SAR data simultaneously from the same angle, enabling real-time fusion instead of post-processing.

GalaxEye plans to cater to both government and commercial customers.

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**SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL SHARES**  
Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-P00/13750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders are informed that, a special window was opened only for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold/ purchased prior to 1<sup>st</sup> April, 2019.

This special window was opened for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.

Shareholders are requested to lodge transfer deed executed prior to April 01, 2019 along with original security certificate(s) and other documents as specified in the above mentioned SEBI circular with the Company latest by 4<sup>th</sup> February, 2027 at the following address:

The Company Secretary, Polyspin Exports Limited, 351, P.A.C.R. Salai, Rajapalayam - 626 117.

For **POLYSPIN EXPORTS LIMITED**  
**A.EMARAJAN**  
**COMPANY SECRETARY**

Place: Rajapalayam  
Date : April 22, 2026

**TATA TATA POWER**  
(Corporate Contracts Department)  
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India  
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)**

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai.

1) Procurement of 22KV/1250KVA PSS for BEST E-Bus under O&M. (Package Reference 4100063887)  
2) Warehouse Management services for TPEVCSL. (Package Reference 4100063606)

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Interested bidders to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter along with Complete Bid Document by **17:00 Hrs, Thursday, 14<sup>th</sup> May 2026**

Also, all future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tender will be informed on website <https://www.tatapower.com> only.

**NCL Natural Capsules Limited**  
CIN No. L85110KA1993PLC014742  
Reg. office: No.23, Trident Towers, 4th Floor, 100 Feet Road, Jayanagar 2nd Block, Bangalore-560011  
Website: www.naturalcapsules.com, E-mail: info@naturalcapsules.com, Contact:080-26561562

**Notice to Shareholders**  
**Sub: Second 100 Days' Campaign- "Saksham Niveshak" for updating KYC and other details**

The Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEFPA), Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") has via intimation dated March 27, 2026, requested companies to relaunch a Second 100- days Campaign "Saksham Niveshak" aimed at reaching out to shareholders whose dividends have remained unpaid/unclaimed. Accordingly, Natural Capsules Limited ("Company") has initiated Second 100 days' Campaign, "Saksham Niveshak" for the shareholders, whose dividends are unpaid/unclaimed and this notice is being issued by the Company as part of the aforesaid campaign.

All the shareholders who have unpaid/unclaimed Dividend or have not updated their KYC and nomination details or have any issues/queries related to unpaid/unclaimed dividends and shares, may write to the Companies Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) i.e. Cameo Corporate Services Limited, "Subramanian Building", No.1, Club House Road, Chennai-600 002 Phone: (D) 04440020710 / 044-2846 0390 Email ID: investor@comesindia.com, else you can also write your concern to the Company at email: company.sec@naturalcapsules.com.

The shareholders may further note that this campaign has been started re-initiated specifically to reach out to the shareholders to claim their Dividend before they get transferred to the Investor Education and Protection fund (IEPF) and to update their KYC details, Contact Details, Bank Account Details, choice of nomination and Specimen Signature.

This notice is also available on the Company's website at [www.naturalcapsules.com](http://www.naturalcapsules.com) and the websites of Stock Exchanges where the Equity shares of the are listed i.e. BSE Limited at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com).

For Natural Capsules Limited  
Sd/  
Pranjal Deshmukh  
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Bangalore  
Date: 23/04/2026

**TATA TATA POWER**  
(Corporate Contracts Department)  
The Tata Power Company Limited, 2<sup>nd</sup> Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Sahar Airport Road, Andheri East, Mumbai-400059  
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)**

Tata Power Company Limited issues Corrigendum - 1 to tender published (Two Part Bidding) on 16<sup>th</sup> April 2026.

Original Tender Name: Miscellaneous Civil works for GIS Building at Kalwa sub-station (**Package Reference No: CC27SVP001**)  
Revised Tender Name: Civil works for 220KV Outdoor GIS & its associated works at Bhandup Sub-station. (**Package Reference No: CC27SVP001**)

Interested & eligible bidders for above package to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter before 15:00 Hrs. Tuesday, 28th April 2026.

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (**Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents**) only.

**TATA TATA POWER**  
(Corporate Contracts Department)  
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 3rd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India  
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)**

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding).

(A) Supply and Supervisory services of 145KV Isolators for various transmission station in and around Mumbai (Davdi, Chola, Kalyan, Borivali). (**Package Ref: CC27NK003**).

(B) Supply of 145 kV Current Transformers at Various Transmission Locations in and around Mumbai (Kalyan, Chola, Borivali, Kalwa, Davdi). (**Package Ref: CC26PRD029**).

(C) Supply of 145 kV Potential Transformers at Various Transmission Locations in and around Mumbai (Kalyan, Chola, Borivali, Davdi). (**Package Ref: CC26PRD030**).

(D) Supply of 145 kV Circuit breakers for various transmission station in and around Mumbai (Davdi, Chola, Kalyan, Borivali). (**Package Ref: CC27TP006**).

(E) Outline Agreement of Two years for excavation and associated services for carrying out Preventive and Breakdown Maintenance of EHV cables in Mumbai region. (**Package Ref: CC26AM015**).

For the above-mentioned packages of (A), (B), (C), (D) & (E) the interested and eligible bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter before **1500 hrs. Monday, 04<sup>th</sup> May 2026**.

(F) Corrigendum 4, NIT\_EPC of SITC of 220kV GIS bays along with the PAC & other Auxiliaries at MSETCL Bhandup Substation for LIL0 at 220kV/Kalwa Salsette-5 Line (**Package Ref: CC26ASM003**)

(G) Corrigendum 1, NIT\_EPC of 400 kV GIS & associated equipment along with Civil Works for 400 kV GIS Receiving Stations at Dhavar & Ghatkopar in Mumbai (**Package Ref: CC27AA001**)

For the above-mentioned packages of (F) and (G) the interested and eligible bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter before **1500 hrs. Thursday, 30<sup>th</sup> April 2026**.

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (**Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents**) only.

**TATA TATA TELESERVICES (MAHARASHTRA) LIMITED**  
Regd. Office: D-26, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC Sanpada, P.O. Turbhe, Navi Mumbai - 400 703  
Tel.: 91-22-6661 5111, e-mail: investor.relations@tatatel.co.in, website: www.tatelebusiness.com  
Corporate Identification Number : L64200MH1995PLC086354  
(Rs. in Crores, except per share data)

**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026**

| Sr. No. | Particulars                                                                                                                                              | Quarter ended            |                               | Year ended               |                          |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|         |                                                                                                                                                          | March 31, 2026 (Audited) | December 31, 2025 (Unaudited) | March 31, 2026 (Audited) | March 31, 2025 (Audited) |
| 1       | Total income from operations                                                                                                                             | 295.54                   | 294.31                        | 308.27                   | 1,160.23                 |
| 2       | Net (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)                                                                                             | (81.87)                  | (146.38)                      | (306.42)                 | (870.25)                 |
| 3       | Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)                                                                                    | 580.93                   | (150.43)                      | (306.42)                 | (215.30)                 |
| 4       | Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax                                                                                                               | 580.93                   | (150.43)                      | (306.42)                 | (215.30)                 |
| 5       | Total Comprehensive Income/(Loss) for the period [Comprising Net Income/(Loss) for the period after tax and Other Comprehensive Income/(Loss) after tax] | 581.10                   | (150.86)                      | (308.90)                 | (212.62)                 |
| 6       | Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value of Rs.10 each)                                                                                                  | 1,954.93                 | 1,954.93                      | 1,954.93                 | 1,954.93                 |
| 7       | Other Equity (including reserves)                                                                                                                        |                          |                               | (21,938.31)              | (21,525.22)              |
| 8       | Network                                                                                                                                                  |                          |                               | (19,983.38)              | (19,567.47)              |
| 9       | Earning/(Loss) per equity share (Face value of Rs.10 each)#                                                                                              |                          |                               |                          |                          |
|         | - Basic and Diluted (In Rs.)                                                                                                                             | 2.97                     | (0.77)                        | (1.57)                   | (1.10)                   |
| 10      | Debt Equity Ratio - [no. of times]                                                                                                                       | (1.03)                   | (1.03)                        | (1.04)                   | (1.03)                   |
| 11      | Debt Service Coverage Ratio ('DSCR') - [no. of times]#                                                                                                   | 0.03                     | 0.04                          | 0.02                     | 0.11                     |
| 12      | Interest Service Coverage Ratio ('ISCR') - [no. of times]#                                                                                               | 0.97                     | 1.02                          | 0.89                     | 0.90                     |

# Not annualized for the quarter ended

1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026, filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 is available on the Stock Exchange websites ([www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com)) and on the website of the Company (<http://www.tatelebusiness.com>).

2 (a) Exceptional items comprise of the following:  
The company has received a demand of Rs. 3.80 Crores from Term Cell of Department of Telecommunications (DoT) pertaining to legacy mobility subscribers connections for the period FY 2007-08 to FY 2011-12 which has been provided in the books of account during the quarter ended June 30, 2025 and the year ended March 31, 2026.

(b) The Government of India on November 21, 2025 consolidated 29 existing labour legislations into a unified framework comprising four Labour Codes, viz., Code on Wages 2019, Code on Social Security 2020, Industrial Relations Code 2020 and Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code 2020 ( 'New Labour Codes'). The Ministry of Labour & Employment has published draft Central Rules and FAQs to enable assessment of the financial impact due to notification of New Labour Codes. The Company has assessed and disclosed the incremental impact of these changes on the basis of opinion obtained and consistent with guidance provided by The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI). Considering the non-recurring nature of this impact, the Company has disclosed such Statutory impact of New Labour Codes under exceptional items in results for the quarter ended December 31, 2025 and year ended March 31, 2026. The incremental impact consisting of gratuity cost of Rs. 3.98 Crores and leave encashment cost of Rs. 0.07 Crores primarily arise due to changes in wage definition.

(c) The Hon'ble Supreme Court of India (SC), vide its judgment dated October 24, 2019, upheld the definition of Adjusted Gross Revenue (AGR) as interpreted by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), resulting in significant liabilities for the telecom operators. Subsequently, on July 20, 2020, and September 01, 2020, the SC passed orders treating as final the calculations submitted by DoT in its application, which mentioned an amount of Rs. 16,798 Crores recoverable from the Tata Group of Companies (the AGR Dues) and directed that no dispute can be raised about it and no recalculation and self-assessment can be undertaken. The SC further ordered Telecommunications Service Provider (TSPs) to pay 10% of the total AGR dues, as demanded by DoT, by March 31, 2021, and to discharge the balance in ten equal annual instalments from April 1, 2021 to March 31, 2031, with each instalment payable by March 31 of the relevant year. AGR dues of Rs. 16,798 Crores were apportioned between the Company and its holding company, Tata Teleservices Limited (TTSL), based on internal estimates. While AGR was computed on a year-wise basis, DoT did not provide a circle-wise break-up. Accordingly, the Company continued to recognize interest on AGR Dues in compliance with the accounting standards, without prejudice to its legal rights, claims, remedies and contentions available under law. DoT also raised multiple Spectrum Usage Charges (SUC) claims for the financial years till 2016-17 that should have been part of the SC order. The Government of India announced relief measures for telecom service providers, pursuant to which DoT, vide its communications dated October 14, 2021, and June 15, 2022, amongst other things, granted an option of a four-year moratorium on AGR dues up to FY 2018–19, i.e., covering (i) dues up to FY 2016–17 mentioned in the SC order, and (ii) additional dues for the period up to FY 2018–19 not covered by the Supreme Court order. The Company and TTSL exercised the option of both categories of AGR Dues. However, they did not opt for conversion of interest into equity and elected to pay the interest along with the AGR dues on the due dates as per the terms of the moratorium.

The four year moratorium period has ended, and under its terms, the AGR dues are payable in six equal annual instalments, with the first instalment due by March 31, 2026. The Company and TTSL also approached the Hon'ble Supreme Court multiple times to allow correction of errors including reverification of the documents for allowing pass-through costs that were outside of the AGR judgement, however the SC did not allow correction of errors and/or reverification of documents and maintained the tabulated AGR Dues at Rs. 16,798 Crores for Tata Group of Companies. During the current quarter, DoT has shared with the Company its final AGR outstanding up to FY19 and the schedule of six annual Instalments commencing from March 31, 2026. While the DoT letters provide break up of AGR outstanding for the Company and TTSL separately, circle/year wise calculation of dues have still not been made available. Pursuant to the documents available for AGR instalment payments for both the Moratoriums, the Company reassessed the provisions relating to License fee and SUC including penalty and interest on penalty, resulting in a write-back of provision amounting to Rs. 666.70 Crores (while the equivalent amount has been added in the outstanding amount of TTSL) to align the carrying value of provisions with the revised liability as per final outstanding shared by DoT. The aforesaid adjustment represents a revision in estimates in accordance with Ind AS 37 and Ind AS 8. Considering the nature and materiality of the item, the same has been disclosed as an exceptional item in the financial statements. Further, the Company has paid the annual installment due on March 31, 2026, amounting to Rs. 615.42 Crores for AGR dues (LF and SUC dues) tabulated in the SC Orders and Rs. 37.56 Crores for AGR related dues up to the financial year 2018-19 not tabulated in the SC Orders. The Company has also filed the stipulated compliance affidavit in The Hon'ble Supreme Court on April 06, 2026.

(d) During the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026, the Company recognized expenses of Rs. 3.90 Crores on vendor reconciliation, in relation to the Consumer Mobility Business demerged in 2019.

3 During the year, the company has reassessed the useful life of certain categories of network assets based on internal assessment and technical evaluation, and accordingly has revised the estimate of its useful life from 18 years to 25 years in respect of those assets. Consequently, the depreciation charge for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 is lower by Rs. 5.90 Crores and Rs. 23.91 Crores respectively.

4 The above financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at its meeting held on April 23, 2026.

Place : Mumbai  
Date : April 23, 2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors  
Harjit Singh  
Managing Director  
DIN No. 09416905



For and on behalf of the Board of Directors  
Harjit Singh  
Managing Director  
DIN No. 09416905





QUICKLY.

**TII to invest further in its arm 3xper Innoventure**



**Chennai:** Tube Investments of India (TII), a part of the Murugappa group, has entered into an agreement with 3xper Innoventure, a subsidiary, and with N Govindarajan (CEO of 3xper) for further investments of ₹75 crore by TII and ₹25 crore by Govindarajan for subscription to compulsorily convertible preference shares (CCPS). The proposed investment by TII and Govindarajan in 3xper will be made at a face value of ₹100 per CCPS, TII said. **OUR BUREAU**

**India extends airspace closure for Pak aircraft**

**New Delhi:** India has extended the ban on Pakistan planes from using its airspace till May 24. With this, the closure of the Indian airspace for Pakistan aircraft will now be in place for over a year — a move that first came days after the Pahalgam terror attack. Since April last year, both countries have been extending the closure of their airspaces for each other's planes. On Tuesday, Pakistan extended the airspace closure till May 24. The ban will be effective till 2359 hours (UTC) on May 23.**PTI**

**BharatGen, L&T arms tie up for Compute platform**

**Mumbai:** L&T Semiconductor Technologies, Larsen & Toubro-Vyoma and BharatGen Technology Foundation have signed a five-year MoU to build an end-to-end Sovereign AI compute platform. Under this partnership, LTSTC will provide custom AI chips such as AI ASIC and xPU silicon platforms to handle sovereign AI workloads based on BharatGen models. The other L&T unit focusing on data centre and cloud services will enable AI-ready compute environments through the 30-MW facility in Kanchipuram. **OUR BUREAU**

# Healthcare tech co Medtronic brings in device to treat Parkinson’s disease

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

Healthcare technology company Medtronic has brought in its Adaptive Deep Brain Stimulation (aDBS) system, a device that can help treat patients with Parkinson’s disease.

India is home to about 10 per cent of the global Parkinson’s disease burden — a public health concern, a note from the company said.

**TREATMENT OPTIONS**

Parkinson’s is a progressive neurological condition, which that can, over time, make routine activities such

# ‘New online gaming rules will drive long-term investment for industry’

**WELCOME MOVE.** Experts say it is a progressive step to position India as a global hub

**S Ronendra Singh**  
New Delhi

The online gaming industry welcomed the newly notified online gaming rules, saying it is a progressive step toward positioning India as a global hub for interactive entertainment and competitive video gaming.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology notified the rules under the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, introducing a “light-touch” approach where most online social games will not require mandatory registration or classification. The rules will come into force from May 1.

“The policy direction marks a decisive shift toward building a globally-aligned video gaming industry in India. Treating casual gaming as entertainment not only unlocks wider audience participation but also accelerates the formal recognition of video gaming as a mainstream storytelling, cultural platform,” Rajan Navani, Chairman, Jetsynthesys, and



**FORWARD LOOKING.** The policy direction marks a decisive shift toward building a globally-aligned video gaming industry

President, Indian Digital Gaming Society, told *businessline*.

The industry believed this will drive long-term investment, innovation and global competitiveness for Indian video gaming companies, he said. “It is important for all stakeholders to ensure that the framework for esports remains enabling so that the ecosystem, from grassroots players to professional leagues, can scale efficiently,” he added.

**MORE CLARITY**  
Sagar Nair, Head of Incuba-

tion, LVL Zero Incubator, said that clarity in regulation is one of the most critical enablers for innovation, and this framework helps remove long-standing ambiguity that founders have had to navigate.

“By clearly distinguishing esports and non-money gaming from online money gaming, the Act creates a more predictable environment for builders to focus on creating high-quality gaming experiences, scalable IPs and globally-relevant products,” Nair said.

Akshat Rathee, Co-

founder and Managing Director of NODWIN Gaming, said that the introduction of a 90-day determination process strikes the right balance between regulatory scrutiny and certainty.

“The explicit exclusion of online money games from being classified as esports is another critical step,” he said.

**GAPS STILL EXIST**

However, Animesh Agarwal, Co-founder and CEO, S8UL, that there are still important gaps.

“Esports teams and players continue to face a lack of clarity on financial frameworks, with ongoing challenges in how banks differentiate between esports earnings and real money gaming. There is also no clear pathway today to formally register esports teams as entities within a defined structure.”

Addressing these areas will be critical for the ecosystem to “move from early structure to full legitimacy and long-term sustainability,” he said.

# International flights from Navi Mumbai delayed, expansion plans on track

**Anees Phadnis**  
Mumbai



**GEARING UP.** Daily traffic at the Navi Mumbai airport is expected to grow to 50,000 passengers by December **BLOOMBERG**

The ongoing conflict in West Asia has pushed back the start of international flights from Navi Mumbai airport, but domestic flights are seeing an increase in loads, a senior executive said on the sidelines of Airports 360 Expo on Thursday.

Domestic flights at Navi Mumbai began last Christmas and frequency has now increased to 156 services daily.

The airport is handling around 20,000 passengers daily, with the number of passengers per flight increasing from around 155 to 170. Daily traffic is expected to grow to 50,000 passengers by December, he said.

International flights from Navi Mumbai were expected to start from March-end, but plans have now got postponed due to the ongoing Iran-US conflict and the resultant increase in jet fuel price.

The senior executive said IndiGo was planning to start international flights from Navi Mumbai from March 29 but that has been deferred now. “I can’t put an exact

date for the start of international flights,” he said.

**AIRPORT EXPANSION**

The airport expansion, however, remains on track and is not impacted by the conflict. Planning and design work for the second terminal is underway and construction is expected to start after the monsoon season. The second terminal will increase passenger handling capacity from 20 million to 50 million. “We are looking at simplified designs and standardised equipment. Wherever possible, we will use precast material,” he added.

As per the master plan, the

Navi Mumbai airport will be developed in five phases with an eventual handling capacity of 90 million passengers per year. According to the executive, the Adani Group will invest around ₹80,000 crore in the project, covering both airport expansion and land-side development.

The Navi Mumbai airport has also requested the Maharashtra government to reduce value-added tax on aviation turbine fuel to 1 per cent from the existing 18 per cent. “Greenfield airport like ours have their own challenges and hand-holding from the government is required to support growth,” he said

# Led by iPhones, ‘Made in India’ smartphone exports grow 28% in CY25

**S Ronendra Singh**  
New Delhi

‘Made in India’ smartphone sales grew 8 per cent year on year in calendar year (CY) 2025, driven by a 28 per cent surge in exports and a 1 per cent growth in domestic sell-in, said a Counterpoint Research report on Thursday.

iPhone maker Foxconn Hon Hai emerged as the key beneficiary with a 48 per cent growth in its exports, driven by strong Apple shipments, it said, adding that Tata Electronics, also a key assembler of Apple devices, further contributed to this export surge. Samsung’s in-house production saw an uptick in its export contribution as well, recording a 4 per cent growth. According to the

market research firm’s ‘Make in India’ tracker, exports accounted for around one-third of all smartphones manufactured in India.

**EXPORT SURGE**

“Exports are becoming increasingly central not only for India-based smartphone electronics manufacturing services (EMS) players but also for the country’s broader export strategy. Electronics grew to become the third largest export category in 2025, driven largely by smartphones, and is on track to become the second largest category in 2026,” Tarun Pathak, Research Director at Counterpoint Research, said.

The government’s recognition of this sector’s growing importance is evident in



**RIISING SHIPMENTS.** iPhone maker Foxconn Hon Hai emerged as the key beneficiary with a 48 per cent growth in exports, driven by strong Apple shipments **REUTERS**

the SEZ reforms notified last year, budgetary support and reforms announced in this year’s Budget and the most recent FDI relaxations, he said. “However, near-term

headwinds such as disruptions due to the US-Iran war could impact logistics, while sustained increases in memory prices may create demand-side pressures over

the longer term,” Pathak added.

**PLI SCHEME**

“Domestic EMS players continue to expand even as the first phase of the PLI scheme nears completion. This has been possible due to exports and sustained premiumisation in the domestic market,” Prachir Singh, Senior Research Analyst, Counterpoint Research, said.

He also added that rising memory prices will be a key challenge, especially as the smartphone market is projected to decline this year, impacting topline.

The growth of the component ecosystem, supported by government initiatives such as the Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme, will be crucial in in-

creasing domestic value addition.

Diversification beyond smartphones into tablets and laptops will be key to tackling these headwinds. Going upstream to develop a robust component ecosystem is another avenue, and several manufacturers have already taken steps in this direction through joint ventures covering displays, camera modules and mechanics.

Government support in the form of faster JV approvals, alongside exploration of a second phase of the smartphone PLI scheme, one designed with a sharper focus on sustaining export momentum, will be crucial in ensuring India consolidates its position as a global smartphone manufacturing hub, Singh added.

# No end to war in sight; Iran tightens grip on Hormuz

**Reuters**  
Washington/Dubai/Islamabad

Iran seized two ships in the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) as it tightened its grip on the strategic waterway after US President Donald Trump announced he was indefinitely calling off attacks, with no sign of peace talks restarting.

The status of a two-week-old ceasefire, due to have expired earlier this week, remained unclear. Hours after threatening renewed violence, Trump made what appeared to be a unilateral announcement on Tuesday.

But Iranian officials did not say they had agreed to any extension of the truce, and criticised Trump’s de-

cision to maintain the US Navy blockade of Iran’s trade by sea, considered by Iran an act of war. Iran’s lead negotiator Mohammad Bager Qalibaf said a full ceasefire only made sense if the blockade was lifted.

**IRAN’S COUNTER**

Reopening the SoH, the slender chokepoint that carried a fifth of the world’s oil trade before the war, was impossible with such a “flagrant breach of the ceasefire,” Qalibaf said on social media.

“You did not achieve your goals through military aggression and you will not achieve them by bullying either,” he wrote in his first response to Trump’s an-



nouncement. “The only way is recognising the Iranian people’s rights.”

Trump again backed away at the last moment from his repeated threats to bomb Iran’s power plants and other civilian infrastructure, which the UN and others

warn would violate international humanitarian law. But little progress has been made in ending the war that started on February 28. That leaves the two sides in a holding pattern with the crucial SoH still effectively shut, straining economies across the world.

The Revolutionary Guards accused the ships it had seized, the Liberia-flagged Epaminondas and Panama-flagged MSC Francesca, of operating without required permits and tampering with their navigation systems. A third — Liberia-flagged container ship — was fired upon in the same area but was not damaged and had resumed sailing, according to maritime security sources.

# Tesla boosts capex to \$25 b for AI, robotics

**Bloomberg**

Tesla Inc anticipates billions of dollars in additional spending this year to support Elon Musk’s ambitions to transform the electric vehicle pioneer into an artificial intelligence and robotics company. Capital expenditure in 2026 will exceed \$25 billion, the company disclosed along with its earnings on Wednesday, roughly three times last year’s outlay. The planned investment is up from a prior forecast of around \$20 billion.

The investments will be put toward expansion of factory operations, including production of Optimus humanoid robots, AI initiatives and the autonomous Cybercab. Tesla’s traditional auto business has declined in the past two years, putting greater pressure on the planned pivot to those futuristic initiatives.

# From Mumbai’s kitchen to Ladakh’s yak farms, India’s artisanal cheese goes global in Brazil

Indian entries at the Mundial do Queijo do Brasil 2026 won four medals across categories

**Avinash Nair**  
Ahmedabad

From corporate corridors to curdled milk, India’s artisanal cheese movement is being shaped by two very different journeys — one emerging from Mumbai’s start-up kitchens and the other from Ladakh’s nomadic pastures.

While Mausam Narang left a corporate career at Cargemini to build Eleftheria Cheese in Mumbai, another story was unfolding nearly 3,000 km away in the high-altitude cold deserts of Ladakh, where Thenlay Nurboo was quietly redefining yak milk into an artisanal product rooted in tradition.

The two were among India’s standout winners at the Mundial do Queijo do Brasil 2026, where Indian entries won four medals



Thenlay Nurboo

across categories, marking a notable debut on the global cheese stage.

**HOME KITCHEN**

For Narang, the journey began in a home kitchen after returning from abroad with a simple craving for better cheese. Over weekends, she experimented

with milk sourced from farmers in Maharashtra, gradually building Eleftheria into a full-fledged artisanal brand. Today, the company partners with multiple family-run farms and produces a range of cheeses that blend European techniques with Indian ingredients and geography. In contrast, Nur-



Mausam Narang

boo’s story is anchored in scale and terrain. Working from his ‘Nomadic farm’ in Durbuk, he produces just 8-9 kg of cheese at a time, relying entirely on yak milk sourced from his herd of around 150 animals. “This Yak Churpi is made from yak milk and is not available anywhere else in India other than Ladakh,” he said, adding that while similar variants exist in Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh, Ladakh’s version is distinct in texture and process. Yak Churpi is already a staple in

Ladakh’s food culture, widely consumed in noodle shops and as instant food, reflecting its deep integration into local diets rather than niche gourmet positioning.

Nurboo’s path to cheesemaking, however, was not linear. Having learnt the craft from his parents nearly a decade ago, he initially experimented with recreating cheese from other regions, even travelling to Nepal to study different varieties.

**TRADITIONAL FORMS**

Eventually, he shifted focus back to indigenous production, choosing to work with yak milk in its most traditional forms. Alongside Churpi, he now produces butter, *lassi*, *ghee* and whey.

Together, these two represent two ends of India’s emerging artisanal dairy spectrum. At the Brazil com-

petition, both narratives converged on a global platform, where blind tastings judged cheeses purely on texture, flavour and craftsmanship. Narang’s Gulmarg (Brie-style) won Super Gold, while Nurboo’s Yak Churpi earned Gold recognition.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in a public message, said India had “made an impressive debut” at the Brazil competition, adding that such successes strengthen the country’s artisanal dairy sector on the global stage.

Nurboo said that he had sent his product to the Brazil-based competition through the National Dairy Development Board. Churpi is known for its long shelf life and unique texture. “For communities in remote areas, these products are not only a dietary staple but also a means of preserving milk

for long winters,” said Dr Satnazin Rabgaia, Chief Animal Husbandry Officer, Leh.

**CRAFTSMANSHIP**

“Artisanal cheese is about craftsmanship — it is 100 per cent dairy, made from good-quality milk and fermented over time,” Narang explained.

“It was important for us to pay a premium and incentivise farmers to consistently deliver the right quality of milk.”

The company, which initially used familiar European names, has gradually shifted to Indian ones as acceptance grew. “Gulmarg, for instance, is named for its snow-like rind, while Konark resembles the wheels of the Sun Temple,” she noted.

With inputs from Gulzar Bhat in Rinagar

| Company         | Prev     | Close    | Open     | High     | Low      | Qty    | 52WH     | 52WL     | PE | BSE CL   |
|-----------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|--------|----------|----------|----|----------|
| 20 Microns [5]  | 178.38   | 180.77   | 178.90   | 185.50   | 176.61   | 144.71 | 284.10   | 130.50   | 11 | 180.00   |
| AKS Chem [1]    | 105.49   | 105.80   | 105.80   | 106.00   | 105.50   | 100.00 | 105.50   | 105.50   | 10 | 105.50   |
| 38 BLACKCO [5]  | 115.55   | 129.134  | 140.00   | 135.95   | 126.30   | 8.44   | 104.00   | 126.30   | 38 | 140.00   |
| 38 BLACKCO [5]  | 32550.00 | 33800.00 | 33800.00 | 33800.00 | 32485.00 | 4.35   | 38300.00 | 28300.00 | 14 | 33800.00 |
| SPAINA [1]      | 338.54   | 336.59   | 335.10   | 362.39   | 331.33   | 166.95 | 435.00   | 245.00   | 36 | 337.00   |
| 61 MoonTech [1] | 71.10    | 69.45    | 70.00    | 72.60    | 69.20    | 116.44 | 113.00   | 465.55   | 76 | 69.30    |

|                   |          |          |          |          |          |        |          |          |     |
|-------------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|--------|----------|----------|-----|
| Adairg [5]        | 489.50   | 488.55   | 489.50   | 495.50   | 484.05   | 110.22 | 547.00   | 411.30   |     |
| Adairg [5]        | 305.25   | 309.00   | 302.00   | 320.00   | 305.25   | 100.00 | 305.25   | 305.25   | 10  |
| Arti Drugs [1]    | 366.95   | 371.55   | 368.95   | 379.00   | 362.57   | 252.52 | 547.00   | 513.60   | 18  |
| Arti Ind [1]      | 470.00   | 465.90   | 468.00   | 480.00   | 463.00   | 113.24 | 494.00   | 338.20   | 46  |
| Arti Ind [1]      | 693.95   | 688.55   | 691.55   | 703.00   | 685.05   | 115.39 | 700.00   | 585.00   | 10  |
| Arti Ind [1]      | 399.95   | 402.15   | 399.95   | 426.00   | 395.00   | 33.27  | 653.10   | 316.00   |     |
| Aavas [1]         | 1392.00  | 1411.30  | 1385.00  | 1446.00  | 1383.00  | 339.61 | 2338.35  | 1050.25  | 18  |
| Av Capital [1]    | 35.70    | 34.97    | 34.25    | 35.45    | 34.65    | 442.21 | 60.25    | 186.00   | 31  |
| Av Capital [1]    | 1019.50  | 1047.45  | 1005.00  | 1078.00  | 1005.00  | 146.02 | 1082.25  | 593.85   |     |
| Av Capital [1]    | 15.08    | 15.59    | 15.33    | 16.24    | 14.99    | 283.66 | 24.88    | 14.30    |     |
| Av Capital [1]    | 141.93   | 142.30   | 141.90   | 144.70   | 141.10   | 151.77 | 253.90   | 1080.10  |     |
| Av Capital [1]    | 107.45   | 107.45   | 107.45   | 107.45   | 107.45   | 107.45 | 107.45   | 107.45   |     |
| ABB [2]           | 7537.00  | 7575.57  | 7580.00  | 7650.00  | 7533.75  | 376.86 | 7874.00  | 964.50   | 76  |
| ABB Powerpro [1]  | 3085.00  | 3172.00  | 3085.00  | 3187.00  | 3085.00  | 193.85 | 3185.00  | 1313.00  |     |
| Adopt [1]         | 25420.00 | 25420.00 | 25420.00 | 25420.00 | 25420.00 | 10.09  | 25420.00 | 25420.00 | 35  |
| Adopt [1]         | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adopt [1]         | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adopt [1]         | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Action Solar [1]  | 93.40    | 91.65    | 93.40    | 93.90    | 91.40    | 238.00 | 139.00   | 74.10    | 25  |
| Actuata Chem [1]  | 242.20   | 238.60   | 241.90   | 245.00   | 237.90   | 24.30  | 234.00   | 104.00   |     |
| Actuata Chem [1]  | 228.60   | 228.60   | 228.60   | 228.60   | 228.60   | 228.60 | 228.60   | 228.60   |     |
| Actuata Green [1] | 119.95   | 121.15   | 119.95   | 124.00   | 118.00   | 67.65  | 133.00   | 127.00   | 23  |
| Adani Ports [1]   | 158.60   | 160.20   | 157.50   | 161.00   | 156.60   | 240.68 | 161.15   | 1181.70  | 186 |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 21.65    | 21.48    | 21.60    | 21.75    | 21.22    | 535.98 | 21.60    | 10.10    | 40  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55 | 203.55   | 203.55   |     |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 15.19    | 14.70    | 15.20    | 15.75    | 15.15    | 10.34  | 20.37    | 95.03    | 14  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 144.62   | 142.10   | 143.90   | 144.30   | 142.00   | 128.95 | 1123.30  | 1250.00  | 11  |
| Adani Pwr [2]     | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   | 203.55   |          |        |          |          |     |

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